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Techniques for generating collection of images

Abstract

This disclosure describes, in part, techniques for retrieving images based on detecting events. For instance, system(s) may detect an event, such as an event associated with a collection of images for an item. Based on detecting the event, the system(s) may determine an area within a facility, such as an inventory location, for retrieving image data. The system(s) may then determine one or more imaging devices that have field(s) of view of the area. Additionally, the system(s) may score the imaging device(s) based on visibility data associated with the imaging device(s). The system(s) may also determine occlusion data for image data generated by the imaging device(s). Using the scores and the occlusion data, the system(s) may then select image data that represents the area. The system(s) may then store the image data in one or more data stores, such as with the collection of images.

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

(1) A materials handling facility, such as a warehouse or a retail store, often provides a user with a tote (e.g., carts, baskets, etc.) to facilitate the processes by which the user locates, identifies,

retrieves, and transports items at the facility. While the user is retrieving or transporting the items within the facility, cameras located within the facility may capture images of the items. A system may then analyze the images in order to try and identify the items retrieved by the user. To perform the analysis, the system may use other images of the item, where these other images are provided to the system before the items are placed within the facility.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF FIGURES

- (1) The detailed description is set forth with reference to the accompanying figures. In the figures, the left-most digit(s) of a reference number identifies the figure in which the reference number first appears. The use of the same reference numbers in different figures indicates similar or identical items or features.
- (2) FIG. 1 illustrates a flow diagram of an example process for retrieving image data representing an inventory location, in accordance with examples of the present disclosure.
- (3) FIG. 2 illustrates an example process for retrieving image data representing an inventory location, in accordance with examples of the present disclosure.
- (4) FIGS. 3A-3B illustrate examples of identifying accessible regions associated with inventory locations, in accordance with examples of the present disclosure.
- (5) FIG. 4 illustrates examples of selecting regions of inventory locations, in accordance with examples of the present disclosure.
- (6) FIG. 5 illustrates an example of determining a visibility score for an imaging device, in accordance with examples of the present disclosure.
- (7) FIG. 6 illustrates an example of determining occlusions associated with images and then selecting an image based on the occlusions, in accordance with examples of the present disclosure.
- (8) FIG. 7 illustrates an example of filtering imaging devices based on scores, in accordance with examples of the present disclosure.
- (9) FIG. 8 illustrates an example of processing image data representing an image, in accordance with examples of the present disclosure.
- (10) FIG. 9 illustrates a flow diagram of an example process for detecting an event and then, based on detecting the event, updating a collection of images, in accordance with examples of the present disclosure.
- (11) FIG. 10 illustrates an example of prioritizing items when collecting image data for collections of images, in accordance with examples of the present disclosure.
- (12) FIG. 11 illustrates an example of updating a collection of images associated with an item, in accordance with examples of the present disclosure.
- (13) FIG. 12 illustrates a flow diagram of an example process for retrieving image data representing an area within a facility, in accordance with examples of the present disclosure.
- (14) FIG. 13 illustrates a flow diagram of an example process for generating and/or updating a collection of images associated with an item, in accordance with examples of the present disclosure.
- (15) FIG. 14 is a block diagram of an example materials handling facility that includes sensors and an inventory management system configured to generate output regarding events occurring in the facility using the sensor data, in accordance with examples of the present examples.
- (16) FIG. 15 illustrates a block diagram of one or more systems configured to support operations described herein, in accordance with examples of the present disclosure.
- (17) FIG. 16 illustrates an example of an environment that includes distributed systems that communicate to perform one or more processes described herein, in accordance with examples of the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(18) This disclosure is directed to, at least in part, both techniques for retrieving images of items at a facility as well as techniques for updating collections of images for the items. For instance, system(s) may retrieve image data representing image(s) depicting an item at the facility. To retrieve the image data, the system(s) may determine a location of the item at the facility, such as a location of an inventory location that holds the item. The system(s) may then identify imaging device(s) that include field(s)-of-view (FOV(s)) that include the inventory location and/or the item. After identifying the imaging device(s), the system(s) may analyze image data generated by the imaging device(s) in order to identify images that depict the inventory location and/or the item and which are not obstructed by object(s) within the facility. The system(s) may then store the image data representing the image(s) in one or more data stores, such as part of a collection of images associated with the item. In some examples, based on detecting an event, the system(s) again perform these processes to update the collection of images. Additionally, in some examples, the system(s) may use the collection of images to identify items that are associated with events that occur at the facility.

(19) For more detail, the system(s) may determine to retrieve image data representing images depicting an item and/or an inventory location for which the item is located. In some examples, the system(s) determine to retrieve the image data based on detecting the occurrence of an event, which is described in more detail below. Additionally, or alternatively, in some examples, the system(s) determine to retrieve the image data based on receiving a request for the images, where the request includes information about the item and/or the inventory location. For example, the request may include an identifier of the facility, an identifier of the inventory location, an identifier of the item, a location associated with the inventory location within the facility, a location of the item within the facility, a time period for the images, and/or any other information. As described herein, in some examples, a location may be associated with coordinates, such as a x-coordinate, a y-coordinate, and a z-coordinate within the facility. Additionally, or alternatively, in some examples, a location may be associated with a general area within the facility, such as a floor, a room, a department, and/or any other type of area within the facility.

(20) The system(s) may then identify imaging devices, such as camera devices, that include FOVs of the inventory location and/or the item. For example, the system(s) may initially determine region(s) (referred to, in some examples, as “accessible region(s)”) of the inventory location that is accessible to one or more users. In some examples, the system(s) make the determination based on the type of the inventory location (e.g., a basket, a table, a shelf, a counter, a refrigerator, etc.). For example, the system(s) may determine that a basket is only accessible from a top region and a shelf is only accessible from a front region. The system(s) may then use the accessible region(s) to determine region(s) (referred to, in some examples, as “interested region(s)”) of the inventory location for identifying the imaging devices, using one or more processes described below. After identifying the interested region(s), the system(s) may use the interested region(s) to identify imaging devices that include FOVs representing the interested region(s). In some examples, the system(s) identify the imaging devices by generating a request that includes at least the identifier of the facility, the identifier of the inventory location, the identifier of the item, the interested region(s), the location within the facility for the inventory location, the location(s) within the facility for the interested region(s), the location within the facility for the item, and/or any other information. The remote system(s) may then use the request to retrieve data that identifies the imaging devices.

(21) The system(s) may then determine a respective visibility associated with each of the imaging devices and the inventory location. For example, and for each imaging device, the system(s) may receive and/or generate data (referred to, in some examples, as “visibility data”) representing a percentage of first pixels represented by image data that are associated with the inventory location, a percentage of the first pixels that are associated with one or more obstructing objects, a

percentage of second pixels represented by the image data that are associated with the interested region(s), a percentage of the second pixels that are associated with one or more obstructing objects, a percentage of the inventory location that is visible from the imaging device, a percentage of the interested region(s) that are visible by the imaging device, an angle (e.g., an angle in the x-direction, an angle in the y-direction, and/or an angle in the z-direction) of the imaging device with respect to the inventory location, and/or any other visibility information. The system(s) may then use the visibility data to determine a respective score for each imaging device.

(22) The system(s) may then determine a respective occlusion associated with each of the selected imaging devices and the inventory location. For example, and for each of the selected imaging devices, the system(s) may receive and/or generate data (referred to, in some examples, as “occlusion data”) representing a percentage of the image data that is occluded by one or more users (e.g., a percentage of the pixels that represent the user(s)), a percentage of the first pixels that are obstructed by the user(s) (e.g., the percentage of the inventory location that is obstructed by the user(s) within the image), a percentage of the second pixel(s) that are obstructed by the user(s) (e.g., the percentage of the interested region(s) that are obstructed by the user(s) within the image), segmented portions of the image data that represent various portions of the user(s) (e.g., pixels that represents a head of a user, pixels that represent the arm of the user, pixels that represent the hand of the user, etc.), and/or any other information. The system(s) may then use one or more of the percentages above in order to select at least an image for the imaging device.

(23) For example, the system(s) may compare the percentage to a threshold percentage in order to determine whether the percentage satisfies (e.g., is less than) the threshold percentage or does not satisfy (e.g., is equal to or greater than) the threshold percentage. The threshold percentage may include, but is not limited to, 5%, 10%, 20%, and/or any other percentage. In some examples, and for each imaging device, the system(s) may analyze the images of the video in temporal order and select the first image that is associated with a percentage that satisfies the threshold percentage. In such examples, if the system(s) determine that none of the images within the video include a percentage that satisfies the threshold image, then the system(s) may determine to disregard the imaging device. The system(s) may then output data representing at least the identifier(s) of the imaging device(s) that are associated with selected image(s), timestamp(s) of the selected image(s), and/or any other information.

(24) The system(s) may then filter the imaging devices using the scores from the visibility processing and the output from the obstruction processing. For example, the system(s) may select the imaging device that includes the highest score and a selected image, the two imaging devices that include the two highest scores and selected images, the three imaging devices that include the three highest scores and selected images, and/or so forth. Additionally, when selecting imaging devices based on the scores, the system(s) may select the imaging devices such that there is at least one imaging device that includes a FOV for each of the interested regions. For example, the system(s) may determine that the interested regions for an inventory location include a top region and a front region. The system(s) may also determine that the scores indicate that the three imaging devices with the three highest scores include FOVs of the top region and the fourth imaging device with the fourth highest score includes a FOV of the front region. As such, if the system(s) are selecting only the three imaging devices, then the system(s) may select the two imaging devices with the two highest scores and the fourth imaging device with the fourth highest score.

(25) After filtering the imaging device(s), the system(s) may retrieve the image data representing the selected images for each of the selected imaging device(s). In some examples, to retrieve the image data for an imaging device, the system(s) may generate data representing a request, where the data represents at least the identifier associated with the imaging device and the timestamp associated with the selected image. The system(s) may then use the data to retrieve the image data. In some examples, the system(s) may then process the image data using one or more image processing techniques. For a first example, the system(s) may process the image data by removing

and/or obfuscating pixels that represent user(s). For a second example, the system(s) may process the image data by cropping the selected image to only represent the inventory location, the interested region(s), a specific item, and/or the like. The system(s) may perform similar processes for each of the other selected images for the other selected imaging device(s).

(26) The system(s) may then store the image data representing the selected image(s) in one or more data stores. In some examples, such as when the system(s) determined to retrieve the image data based on detecting an event, the system(s) may store the image data as part of a collection of images associated with an item, which is described in more detail below. In some examples, such as when the system(s) determined to retrieve the image data based on receiving the request, the system(s) may also generate a notification indicating that the image data is stored in the one or more data stores. In some examples, the notification may include a link, an address, and/or any other mechanism for accessing the image data. The system(s) may then send the notification to one or more computing devices associated with the request.

(27) As described in the examples above, the system(s) may retrieve the image data based on detecting the occurrence of an event. In some examples, such as when the system(s) already store a collection of images associated with an item, the event may be associated with a period of time elapsing. For example, the system(s) may store information about the images included in the collection of images, such as timestamps indicating when the image data representing the images was generated. The system(s) may then use the timestamps to determine when to update one or more of the images included in the collection of images. For example, the system(s) may determine to update images after the period of time elapses, where the period of time may include one day, one week, one month, one year, and/or any other period of time. As such, when the system(s) determine that the period of time has elapsed, the system(s) may perform the processes described above (and/or any other retrieval process) to retrieve the image data representing new images depicting the item. The system(s) may then replace the image data representing the older image(s) with the image data representing the new image(s) within the collection of images.

(28) Additionally, or alternatively, in some examples, such as when an item is new and/or the system(s) do not yet store a collection of images for the item, the event may be associated with the item being placed within the facility. For example, the system(s) may receive, from one or more computing devices, data indicating that the item has been placed within the facility. In some examples, the data may represent the identifier of the item, the identifier of the inventory location for which the item was placed, the location of the item within the facility, and/or any other information associated with the placement of the item within the facility. The system(s) may then use the data to determine that the item is either new to the facility and/or that the system(s) have yet to generate the collection of images for the item. As such, the system(s) may perform the processes described above (and/or any other retrieval process) to retrieve the image data representing the image(s) depicting the item within the facility. The system(s) may then store the image data as part of the collection of images for the item.

(29) Additionally, or alternatively, in some examples, the event may be associated with the item being moved from a first inventory location within the facility to a second inventory location within the facility. For example, the system(s) may receive, from one or more computing devices, data indicating that the item has been moved within the facility. In some examples, the data may represent the identifier of the item, the identifier of the second inventory location for which the item was placed, the new location of the item within the facility, and/or any other information associated with the placement of the item within the facility. The system(s) may then use the data to determine that the item was moved within the facility. As such, the system(s) may perform the processes described above (and/or any other retrieval process) to retrieve the image data representing the image(s) depicting the item at the second inventory location. The system(s) may then store the image data as part of the collection of images for the item.

(30) Additionally, or alternatively, in some examples, the event may be associated with an

interaction of the item within the facility. For example, the system(s) may receive, from one or more computing devices, data indicating that the item has been interacted with within the facility. In some examples, the data may represent the identifier of the item, the type of interaction, the time of the interaction, and/or any other information associated with the interaction of the item. As described herein, the interaction may include, but is not limited to, an associate restocking the item at the inventory location, a customer returning the item to the inventory location, the associated and/or the customer rummaging through items at the inventory location, and/or any other type of interaction. The system(s) may then use the data to determine that the interaction occurred with the item. As such, the system(s) may perform the processes described above (and/or any other retrieval process) to retrieve the image data representing the image(s) depicting the item at the inventory location. The system(s) may then store the image data as part of the collection of images for the item.

(31) Additionally, or alternatively, in some examples, the event may be associated with a state of the collection of images. For example, the system(s) may determine that the collection of images is in a first state when a number of images included in the collection of images is less than a first threshold. The system(s) may also determine that the collection of images is in a second state when the number of images included in the collection of images is between the first threshold and a second threshold. As described herein, the first state may include a critical state indicating that more images should be added to the collection of images while the second state includes a non-critical state indicating that the collection of images includes an adequate number of images. Additionally, as described herein, a threshold may include, but is not limited to, 10 images, 20 images, 25 images, 40 images, 50 images, 100 images, and/or any other number of images. As such, the system(s) may analyze the collection of images to determine that the collection of images is in the first state. Based on the determination, the system(s) may perform the processes described above (and/or any other retrieval process) to retrieve the image data representing the image(s) depicting the item at the inventory location. The system(s) may then store the image data as part of the collection of images for the item.

(32) In some examples, such as when the system(s) identify multiple events for multiple items either at one facility or at multiple facilities, the system(s) may prioritize the retrieving of the image data for the items associated with the events. In some examples, the system(s) may prioritize the retrieving of the image data based on the types of events detected by the system(s). For example, the system(s) may determine a first type of event (e.g., a collection of images being in a critical state) includes first priority, a second type of event (e.g., a time period elapsing) includes a second priority that is less than the first priority, a third type of event (e.g., a user interacting with an item) includes a third priority that is less than the second priority, and/or so forth. The system(s) may then use the priorities when retrieving the image data. For example, the system(s) may retrieve the image data associated with item that includes the highest priority, followed by retrieving the image data associated with the item that includes the second highest priority, followed by retrieving the image data associated with the item that includes the third highest priority, and/or so forth.

(33) In some examples, the system(s) may determine times when to retrieve the image data for the items. For example, and for a facility, the system(s) may receive data representing first times that the facility is open to customers and second times that the facility is closed to the customers. For instance, the data may indicate that the facility is open between 9:00 a.m. and 7:00 p.m. each day and closed at all other times. The system(s) may then use the data to determine when to retrieve the image data. For example, the system(s) may determine to retrieve the image data while the store is open to customers and determine not to retrieve the image data when the store is closed to customers. In some examples, the system(s) may determine to retrieve the image data when the store is open to customers since these times will provide better-quality images of the items. For instance, an item may be located on an inventory location with lights, where the lights are turned on when the store is open (and/or when a user interacts with the inventory location) and are turned

off when the store is closed (and/or when no user is interacting with the inventory location). As such, the system(s) may retrieve the image data when the lights are turned on in order to provide a better-quality image of the item.

(34) In some examples, the system(s) (and/or other system(s)) may use the collections of images for the items for one or more purposes. For example, and as described in more detail below, different interactions may occur with an item at a facility. For instance, an associate may restock the item at an inventory location, a customer may remove the item from the inventory location, the customer may return the item to the inventory location, and/or the like. The system(s) may be configured to analyze data, such as image data representing these interactions, in order to determine the identity of the item. As such, to identify the item, the system(s) may analyze the image data representing the interaction using the collection of images in order to determine that the image data represents the item. Since the system(s) are performing this analysis using the collection of images associated with the item, the processing performed by the system(s) may output better results when the collection of images includes a sufficient amount of quality images that are updated to correctly depict the item.

(35) As described herein, an identifier may include, but is not limited to, a numerical identifier, an alphabetic identifier, a mixed numerical and alphabetic identifier, and/or any other type of identifier that may be used to identify a facility, an inventory location, an item, an imaging device, and/or any other feature described herein. For example, an identifier may include a name, a code (e.g., a barcode, a Quick Response (QR) code, etc.), a number (a standard identification number), and/or any other type of identifier.

(36) Although the techniques described herein are with reference to a session of a user in a materials handling facility, the techniques are generally applicable to any item-recognition environment. Other examples may include inventory-management systems automating the intake of new shipments of item inventory, libraries for processing returned books and/or identifying books obtained by a user during a library session, video-rental facilities for processing and sorting returned movies, and so forth.

(37) The following description describes use of the techniques within a materials handling facility. The facility described herein may include, but is not limited to, warehouses, distribution centers, cross-docking facilities, order fulfillment facilities, packaging facilities, shipping facilities, rental facilities, libraries, retail stores, wholesale stores, museums, or other facilities or combinations of facilities for performing one or more functions of materials (inventory) handling. In other implementations, the techniques described herein may be implemented in other facilities or situations.

(38) Certain implementations and embodiments of the disclosure will now be described more fully below with reference to the accompanying figures, in which various aspects are shown. However, the various aspects may be implemented in many different forms and should not be construed as limited to the implementations set forth herein. The disclosure encompasses variations of the embodiments, as described herein. Like numbers refer to like elements throughout.

(39) FIG. 1 illustrates a flow diagram of an example process **100** for retrieving image data representing an inventory location, in accordance with examples of the present disclosure. At **102**, the process **100** may include identifying imaging devices **104(1)-(3)** (also referred to as “imaging devices **104**”) that include fields of view of an inventory location **106**. For instance, the system(s) may identify the imaging devices **104** that include the FOVs of the inventory location **106**. In some examples, to identify the imaging devices **104**, the system(s) initially determine region(s) of the inventory location **106** that are accessible to one or more users, such as the user **108**. In the example of FIG. 1, the system(s) may determine that just a front region **110** of the inventory location **106** is accessible to the user **108**. Based on that determination, the system(s) may determine that an interested region for the inventory location **106** includes the front region **110**. The system(s) may then identify the imaging devices **104** as including the FOVs of the front region **110**.

However, and as discussed in more detail with regard to FIGS. 3 and 4, the system(s) may use other techniques for identifying interested region(s) of other types of inventory locations.

(40) At **112**, the process **100** may include determining scores for the imaging devices **104** that are based on device visibilities **114(1)-(3)** (also referred to as “device visibilities **114**”) of the inventory location **106**. For instance, the system(s) may determine the scores for the imaging devices **104**, where the scores are based on the device visibilities **114**. For example, to determine the score for the imaging device **104(1)**, the system(s) may receive and/or generate visibility data representing a percentage of first pixels represented by image data that are associated with the inventory location **106** (e.g., the percentage of the first pixels that depict the inventory location **106**), a percentage of the first pixels that are associated with one or more obstructing objects (e.g., the percentage of the first pixels that depict the object **116**), a percentage second pixels represented by the image data that are associated with the front region **110** (e.g., the percentage of the second pixels that depict the front region **110**), a percentage of the second pixels that are associated with one or more obstructing objects (e.g., the percentage of the second pixels that depict the object **116**), a percentage of the inventory location **106** that is visible from the imaging device **104(1)**, a percentage of the front region **110** that is visible by the imaging device **104(1)**, an angle (e.g., an angle in the x-direction, an angle in the y-direction, and/or an angle in the z-direction) of the imaging device **104(1)** with respect to the inventory location **106**, and/or any other visibility information.

(41) The system(s) may then use the visibility data to determine a score for the imaging device **104(1)**, which is described in more detail with respect to FIG. 5. The system(s) may then perform similar processes for each of the other imaging devices **104(2)-(3)**. In the example of FIG. 1, the system(s) may determine that the imaging device **104(2)** includes the highest score (e.g., based on the device visibility **114(2)**), the imaging device **104(1)** includes the second highest score (e.g., based on the device visibility **114(1)**), and the imaging device **104(3)** includes the third highest score (e.g., based on the device visibility **114(3)**).

(42) At **118**, the process **100** may include determining whether the inventory location **106** is occluded from the imaging devices **104**. For instance, and for the imaging device **104(1)**, the system(s) may receive and/or generate occlusion data representing a percentage of the image data that is occluded by the user **108**, a percentage of the first pixels that are obstructed by the user **108**, a percentage of the second pixels that are obstructed by the user **108**, segmented portions of the image data that represent various portions of the user **108** (e.g., pixels that represents a head of the user **108**, pixels that represent the arm of the user **108**, pixels that represent the hand of the user **108**, etc.), and/or any other information. The system(s) may then use one or more of the percentages above in order to select at least an image for the imaging device.

(43) For example, the system(s) may compare the percentage to a threshold percentage in order to determine whether the percentage satisfies (e.g., is less than) the threshold percentage or does not satisfy (e.g., is equal to or greater than) the threshold percentage. As described herein, the threshold percentage may include, but is not limited to, 5%, 10%, 20%, and/or any other percentage. In some examples, when analyzing the image data, the system(s) may analyze the images of the video represented by the image data in temporal order and then select the first image that is associated with a percentage that satisfies the threshold percentage. In such examples, if the system(s) determine that none of the images within the video include a percentage that satisfies the threshold image, then the system(s) may determine to disregard the imaging device **104(1)**.

(44) For instance, and in the example of FIG. 1, the system(s) may determine that a first percentage associated with a first image **120(1)** generated by the imaging device **104(1)** does not satisfy the threshold. As such, the system(s) may not select the first image **120(1)**. Additionally, the system(s) may determine that a second percentage associated with a second image **120(2)** generated by the imaging device **104(1)** also does not satisfy the threshold. As such, the system(s) may not select the second image **120(2)**. Furthermore, the system(s) may determine that a third percentage associated

with a third image **120(3)** generated by the imaging device **104(1)** satisfies the threshold. As such, the system(s) may select the third image **120(3)**. The system(s) may then perform similar processes for each of the other imaging devices **104(2)-(3)** (and/or each of the other imaging devices **104** that includes at least a threshold visibility score).

(45) At **122**, the process **100** may include selecting image data generated by one or more of the imaging devices **104**. For instance, the system(s) may then select image data generated by one or more of the imaging devices **104** based on the scores associated with the device visibilities and the occlusion processing. In some examples, the system(s) may select the imaging device **104** that includes the highest score and a selected image, the two imaging devices **104** that include the two highest scores and selected images, the three imaging devices **104** that include the three highest scores and selected images, and/or so forth. Additionally, when selecting imaging devices **104** based on the scores, the system(s) may select the imaging devices **104** such that there is at least one imaging device that includes a FOV for each of the interested regions.

(46) For instance, and in the example of FIG. **1**, the system(s) may select the third image **120(3)** based on the percentage satisfying the threshold and the score associated with the imaging device **104(1)**. The system(s) may also select an image **124** generated by the imaging device **104(2)** based on a percentage associated with the image **124** satisfying the threshold and the score associated with the imaging device **104(2)**. However, the system(s) may determine not to select any image generated by the imaging device **104(3)**. In some examples, the system(s) may determine not to select any image generated by the imaging device **104(3)** based on the score associated with the imaging device **104(3)**. For example, the score may not satisfy (e.g., may be less than) a threshold score. For another example, the system(s) may only select two of the imaging devices **104**, where the imaging device **104(3)** includes the lowest score from among the imaging devices **104**.

Additionally, or alternatively, in some examples, the system(s) may determine not to select any image generated by the imaging device **104(3)** based on the obstruction data associated with the images generated by the imaging device **104(3)**. For example, none of the images may be associated with a percentage that satisfies the threshold.

(47) In some examples, and as described in more detail below, the system(s) may then request the image data representing the third image **120(3)** and the image data representing the image **124**. Additionally, in some examples, the system(s) may crop and/or occlude pixels of the image data that depict the user **108**. Furthermore, in some examples, the system(s) may crop the image data such that the image data represents the inventory location **106** and/or a specific item located at the inventory location **106**. In any of the examples above, the system(s) may then store the image data in one or more data stores.

(48) While the example of FIG. **1** illustrates some of the processes for retrieving the image data, in other examples, the retrieving of the image data may include additional and/or alternative processes. For instance, FIG. **2** illustrates an example process **200** for retrieving the image data representing the inventory location, in accordance with examples of the present disclosure. As shown, input data store(s) **202** may store data representing requests for retrieving image data, where the requests are to retrieve image data representing inventory locations, items, areas within a facility, and/or the like. In some examples, the input data store(s) **202** may be associated with a queue that includes the requests. As described herein, a request may include, but is not limited to, an identifier of a facility, an identifier of an inventory location, an identifier of an item, a location associated with the inventory location within the facility, a location of the item within the facility, a time period for retrieving images, a priority, and/or any other information. In some examples, the system(s) may receive the data representing the requests from one or more computing devices (e.g., from a user requesting the images). In some examples, the system(s) may generate the data representing the requests based on detecting events.

(49) A validation component **204** may then retrieve request data **206** representing a request and analyze the request data **206** in order to validate the request. In some examples, to validate the

request, the validation component **204** may determine that the facility is valid (e.g., the facility exists), determine that the inventory location is valid (e.g., the inventory location is within the facility), determine that the item is valid (e.g., determine that the item is located within the facility and/or at the inventory location), determine that the time period is valid (e.g., determine that a length of the time period is within a threshold length, determine that the time period is during hours the facility is open, etc.), and/or perform one or more additional verification processes. Based on the validation component **204** verifying the request, the validation component **204** may then output the request data **206** and/or data **208** indicating that the request has been verified.

(50) A parsing component **210** may convert the request into an internal task for processing. In some examples, the task may include at least some of the information from the request represented by the request data **206**. The parsing component **210** may then output data **212** representing the task. The output of the data **212** may cause the following processes to occur for receiving image data.

(51) A visibility component **214** may be configured to determine scores for imaging devices. For instance, the visibility component **214** may initially determine region(s) of the inventory for requesting the images. For example, FIGS. 3A-3B illustrates examples of selecting regions of inventory locations, in accordance with examples of the present disclosure. As shown, the visibility component **214** may determine the region(s) for requesting the image data based on the type of inventory location that is indicated by the task.

(52) In the examples of FIGS. 3A-3B, the visibility component **214** may determine the region(s) using data (which may be referred to as “feature data”) representing the inventory locations. In some examples, the inventory locations are represented by cuboids. As such, the feature data may represent at least a volume of the merchandise within the inventory location, a volume of the inventory location, accessibility vectors associated with the inventory location, a location (e.g., coordinates) of the inventory location within the facility, locations (e.g., coordinates) of the regions associated with the inventory location, and/or any other information. In some examples, the accessibility vectors indicate the accessible region(s) of the inventory location.

(53) For a first example of determining the region(s), and for a first type of inventory location **302**, the inventory location **302** may include six regions. As shown, the regions include a front region **304(1)**, a first side region **304(2)**, a second side region **304(3)**, a back region **304(4)**, a top region **304(5)**, and a bottom region (not show). Additionally, and for the inventory location **302**, the visibility component **214** may use the feature data associated with the inventory location **302** in order to determine that the inventory location **302** includes only one accessible region, which is the front region **304(1)** shaded in grey. In some examples, since the only accessible region is the front region **304(1)**, the visibility component **214** may determine that the only interested region is the front region **304(1)**. This may be because views of the other regions of the inventory location **302** may not provide much information about interactions between users and items associated with the inventory location **302**. As such, the visibility component **214** may request imaging devices that include a visibility **306** of the front region **304(1)** of the inventory location **302**.

(54) For a second example, and for a second type of inventory location **308**, the inventory location **308** may also include six regions. As shown, the six regions include a first side region **310(1)**, a second side region **310(2)**, a third side region **310(3)**, a fourth side region **310(4)**, a top region **310(5)**, and a bottom region (not shown). Additionally, and for the inventory location **308**, the visibility component **214** may use the feature data associated with the inventory location **308** to determine that the inventory location **308** also includes only one accessible region, which is the top region **310(5)** shaded in grey. In some examples, since the only accessible region is the top region **310(5)**, the visibility component **214** may determine that the interested regions include the top region **310(5)** and at least a side region **310(1)-(4)**. This may be because interactions between users and items associated with the inventory location **308** may be analyzed from both the top of the inventory location **308** and the sides of the inventory location **308**.

(55) In some examples, and as at least partially illustrated in FIG. 3A, the visibility component **214**

may determine to pick the side region **310(1)-(4)** that includes the largest surface area. For instance, the visibility component **214** may determine a first surface area of the first side region **310(1)**, a second surface area of the second side region **310(2)**, a third surface area of the third side region **310(3)**, and a fourth surface area of the fourth side region **310(4)**. The visibility component **214** may then select the side region **310(1)-(4)** that includes the largest surface area. In the example of FIG. 3A, based on the type of the inventory location **308**, the visibility component **214** may determine that all of the surface areas for all of the side regions **310(1)-(4)** are equal to one another. As such, the visibility component **214** may just pick any one of the side regions **310(1)-(4)**, such as the first side region **310(1)**. Because of this, the visibility component **214** may request imaging devices that include a visibility **312** of the top region **310(5)** and a visibility **314** of the first side region **310(1)**.

(56) Still, for a third example, and for a third type of inventory location **316**, the inventory location **316** may again include six regions. As shown in more detail in the example of FIG. 4, the six regions include a front region **402(1)**, a first side region **402(2)**, a second side region **402(3)**, a back region **402(4)**, a top region **402(5)**, and a bottom region **402(6)**. Additionally, and for the inventory location **316**, the visibility component **214** may use the feature data associated with the inventory location **316** to determine that the inventory location **316** includes multiple accessible regions, such as the front region **402(1)** and the top region **402(5)** shaded in grey. In some examples, the visibility component **214** may also determine that the accessible regions include the first side region **402(2)** and the second side region **402(3)**. In some examples, since there are multiple accessible regions, the visibility component **214** may determine that there are also multiple interested regions associated with the inventory location **316**.

(57) In some examples, the visibility component **214** may determine that the interested regions include each of the accessible regions of the inventory location **316**. For instance, the visibility component **214** may determine that the interested regions include the front region **402(1)**, the top region **402(5)**, the first side region **402(2)**, and/or the second side region **402(3)**. In some examples, the visibility component **214** may determine the interest regions based on the areas of the accessible regions. For instance, the visibility component **214** may determine a first area associated with the front region **402(1)** represented in grey, determine a second area associated with the top region **402(5)** represented in grey, determine a third area associated with the first side region **402(2)** represented in grey, and determine a fourth area associated with the second side region **402(3)** (which may be the same as the third area for the inventory location **316**). In some examples, the visibility component **214** may then select at least one of the front region **402(1)**, the first side region **402(2)**, and the second side region **402(3)**. Additionally, the visibility component **214** may select the top region **402(5)** if the second area associated with the top region **402(5)** is larger than the largest area between the first area associated with the front region **402(1)**, the third area associated with the first side region **402(2)**, and the fourth area associated with the second side region **402(3)**.

(58) After determining the interested regions, and as illustrated again in the example of FIG. 3B, the visibility component **214** may request imaging devices that include a visibility **318** of the front region **402(1)** and a visibility **320** of the top region **402(5)**.

(59) In some examples, and as illustrated in FIGS. 3A-4, the system(s) represent the inventory locations as cuboids. As such, the request may include, but is not limited to, an identifier of the inventory location, identifier(s) of the interested region(s), a location (e.g., the coordinates) within the facility for which the inventory location is located, location(s) (e.g., the coordinates) of the interested region(s), and/or any other information that may help to determine the imaging devices. For example, the request for the inventory location **316** may include, but is not limited to, an identifier of the inventory location **316**, an identifier of the front region **402(1)**, an identifier of the top region **402(5)**, a location (e.g., the coordinates) within the facility for which the inventory location **316** is located, a location (e.g., the coordinates) of the front region **402(1)**, a location (e.g.,

the coordinates) of the top region **402(5)**, and/or any other information that may help to determine the imaging devices.

(60) While the example of FIGS. **3A-3B** illustrate three examples of determining accessible regions and interested regions for three different types of inventory locations, in other examples, the visibility component **214** may perform similar and/or alternative techniques to determine accessible regions and/or interested regions for other types of inventory locations. Additionally, the visibility component **214** may then generate a request for the imaging devices based on the interested regions. The request may include at least the identifier of the facility, the identifier of the inventory location, the identifier of an item, the interested region(s), the location of the facility associated with the inventory location, and/or any other information. Additionally, based on sending the request, the visibility component **214** may receive data that identifies the imaging devices.

(61) The visibility component **214** may then be configured to determine the visibility scores for the imaging devices. For instance, FIG. **5** illustrates an example of determining a visibility score for an imaging device **502**, in accordance with examples of the present disclosure. As shown, and for the visibility **318** of the imaging device **502**, the visibility component **214** may receive and/or generate visibility data representing a percentage of first pixels represented by image data that are associated with the inventory location **316** (which is represented by a dark grey shading **504**), a percentage of the first pixels that are associated with an obstructing object **506** (e.g., which is represented by a light grey shading **508**), a percentage of second pixels represented by the image data that are associated with the front region **402(1)** (which is again represented by the dark grey shading **504**), a percentage of the second pixels that are associated with the obstructing object **506** (e.g., which is again represented by the light grey shading **508**), a percentage of the inventory location **316** that is visible from the imaging device **502**, a percentage of the front region **402(1)** that is visible by the imaging device **502**, an angle **510** (e.g., an angle in the x-direction, an angle in the y-direction, and/or an angle in the z-direction) of the imaging device **502** with respect to the inventory location **316**, and/or any other visibility information.

(62) The visibility component **214** may then use the visibility data to determine the score for the imaging device **502**. For a first example, if the visibility data indicates that an entirety of the inventory location **316** is occluded, then the visibility component **214** may determine that the score for the imaging device **502** is zero. For a second example, if the visibility data indicates that a clipped portion of the inventory location **316** satisfies a threshold, then the visibility component **214** may again determine that the score for the imaging device **502** is zero. For a third example, if the visibility component **214** determines that the percentage of the second pixels that are associated with the obstructing object **506** satisfy (e.g., is equal to or greater than) a threshold, then the visibility component **214** may again determine that the score for the imaging device **502** is zero. While these are just a couple examples techniques for determining a score of zero, in other examples, the visibility component **214** may use additional and/or alternative techniques.

(63) In some examples, the visibility component **214** may determine the score using one or more of the percentages and/or the angle above. When determining the score using such a technique, the visibility component **214** may provide weight(s) to one or more of the percentages and/or the angle. For example, the visibility component **214** may determine the score by multiplying the percentage of the first pixels by a first weight, plus adding the percentage of the first pixels that are not obstructed multiplied by a second weight, plus adding the percentage of the second pixels multiplied by a third weight, plus adding the percentage of the second pixels that are not obstructed multiplied by a fourth score, plus adding an initial score for the angle multiplied by a fifth score. While this is just one example algorithm that the visibility component **214** may use to determine the score, in other examples, the visibility component **214** may use additional and/or alternative algorithms.

(64) The visibility component **214** may then output data **216** representing the scores for the imaging devices. In some examples, the data **216** may represent a list of the imaging devices,

where the list is ordered based on the scores. For example, the imaging device with the highest score may be first on the list, the imaging device with the second highest score may be second on the list, the imaging device with the third highest score may be third on the list, and/or so forth. In some examples, the list may include a threshold number of the imaging devices with the highest scores. In such examples, the threshold number may include, but is not limited to, one imaging device, two imaging devices, three imaging devices, ten imaging devices, and/or any other number of imaging devices. Additionally, or alternatively, in some examples, the list may not include imaging devices that are associated with scores that do not satisfy (e.g., are less than) a threshold score. For example, the list may not include imaging devices with a score of zero.

(65) A video-type selection (STS) component **218** may then determine types of image data that are associated with the imaging devices represented by the data **216** that is output from the visibility component **214**. In some examples, the types of image data may be based on a quality of the videos. For examples, the types of image data associated with the imaging devices may include, but are not limited to, a first type of image data that includes a first resolution (e.g., low-resolution video), a second type of image data that includes a second resolution (e.g., high-resolution video), and/or the like. In some examples, an imaging device may only be associated with a single type of image data while in other examples, an imaging device may be associated with multiple types of images data. The output from the STS component **218** may include data **220** representing the type(s) of image data that are associated with the imaging devices included in the data **216**.

(66) An occlusion-detection component **222** may be configured to determine an occlusion associated with the image data generated by the imaging devices. For instance, and for each of the imaging devices, the occlusion detection component **222** may receive and/or generate occlusion data representing a percentage of the image data that is occluded by one or more users (e.g., the percentage of the pixels that represent the user(s)), a percentage of the first pixels that are obstructed by the user(s) (e.g., the percentage of the inventory location that is obstructed by the user(s) within the image), a percentage of the second pixel(s) that are obstructed by the user(s) (e.g., the percentage of the interested region(s) that are obstructed by the user(s) within the image), segmented portions of the image data that represent various portions of the user(s) (e.g., pixels that represents a head of a user, pixels that represent the arm of the user, pixels that represent the hand of the user, etc.), and/or any other information. The system(s) may then use one or more of the percentages above in order to select at least an image for the imaging device.

(67) For instance, FIG. **6** illustrates an example of determining occlusions associated with images **602(1)-(N)** (also referred to as “images **602**”) and then selecting an image **602** based on the occlusions, in accordance with examples of the present disclosure. In some examples, the occlusion-detection component **222** may receive occlusion data associated with image data **604**, where the image data **604** represents the images **602** (e.g., frames) of a video. In other examples, the occlusion-detection component **222** may receive the image data **604**. In such examples, the occlusion-detection component **222** may then analyze the image data **604** (e.g., analyze the images **602** of the video) in order to generate the occlusion data. In either of the examples, the occlusion-detection component **222** may use the occlusion data to pick at least one of the images **602** of the video.

(68) For example, the occlusion-detection component **222** may begin to analyze the occlusion data representing the images **602** in temporal order starting with the first image **602(1)** of the video. As shown, the occlusion data associated with the first image **602(1)** of the video may represent a percentage of the pixels of the first image **602(1)** that are occluded by a user, where the pixels are represented with grey shading. In some examples, the percentage is associated with an entirety of the first image **602(1)** while in other examples, the percentage is only associated with the pixels of the inventory location (and/or the interested region) that are obstructed by the user. In either of the examples, the occlusion-detection component **222** may compare the percentage to a threshold percentage in order to determine whether the percentage satisfies (e.g., is less than) the threshold

percentage or does not satisfy (e.g., is equal to or greater than) the threshold percentage. As described herein, the threshold percentage may include, but is not limited to, 5%, 10%, 20%, and/or any other percentage.

(69) In the example of FIG. 6, the occlusion-detection component 222 may determine that the percentage for the first image 602(1) does not satisfy the threshold percentage. As such, the occlusion-detection component 222 may determine not to select the first image 602(1). Because of this, the occlusion-detection component 222 may use similar processes in order to analyze the occlusion data associated with the next image of the video, which is the second image 602(2). Again, based on the analysis, the occlusion-detection component 222 may determine that the percentage associated with the second image 602(2) does not satisfy the threshold percentage and, as such, the occlusion-detection component 222 may determine not to select the second image 602(2). The occlusion-detection component 222 may continue this process through the rest of the images 602(3)-(N) until the occlusion-detection component 222 identifies an image 602 for selection.

(70) For instance, and in the example of FIG. 6, the occlusion-detection component 222 may analyze the occlusion data associated with the seventh image 602(7). Based on the analysis, the occlusion-detection component 222 may determine that the percentage associated with the seventh image 602(7) satisfies the threshold percentage. As such, the occlusion-detection component 222 may select the seventh image 602(7) from the video. In some examples, the occlusion-detection component 222 may be configured to select a single image 602 from the video and, as such, the occlusion-detection component 222 may stop analyzing the rest of the images 602(8)-(N). However, in other examples, the occlusion-detection component 222 may be configured to continue analyzing the rest of images 602(8)-(N) in order to attempt to selected one or more of the remaining images 602(8)-(N).

(71) Additionally, the occlusion-detection component 222 may be configured to perform similar processes for each of the other imaging devices. In some examples, if the occlusion-detection component 222 determines that an entirety of a video for an imaging device does not include an image that is associated with a percentage that satisfies the threshold percentage, then the occlusion-detection component 222 may discard the imaging device (e.g., determine not to use the imaging device). Returning back to the example of FIG. 2, the occlusion-detection component 222 may then output data 224 representing information about the selected information. The information for a selected image may include at least an identifier of the imaging device that generated the selected image and a timestamp of when the imaging device generated the selected image.

(72) A filtering component 226 may then be configured to select imaging devices that are associated with selected images (e.g., imaging devices that were not discarded), where the filtering component 226 selects the imaging devices based on the scores. For example, the filtering component 226 may select the imaging device that includes the highest score and a selected image, the two imaging devices that include the two highest scores and selected images, the three imaging devices that include the three highest scores and the selected images, and/or so forth. Additionally, when selecting imaging devices based on the scores, the filtering component 226 may select the imaging devices such that there is at least one imaging device that includes a FOV for each of the interested regions.

(73) For example, FIG. 7 illustrates an example of filtering imaging devices based on scores, in accordance with examples of the present disclosure. As shown, a list 702 may include identifiers for the imaging devices 704(1)-(6) (also referred to as “imaging devices 704”), the scores 706(1)-(6) (also referred to as “scores 706”) for the imaging devices 704, the regions 708(1)-(2) (also referred to as “regions 708”) associated with the imaging devices 704, and whether the imaging devices 704 are associated with selected images 710(1)-(5) (also referred to as “images 710”). In the example of FIG. 7, the filtering component 226 may determine to select three of the imaging devices 704, where at least one of the selected imaging devices 704 must of a FOV of the first

region **708(1)** and at least one of the selected imaging devices **704** must have a FOV of the second region **708(2)**.

(74) As such, and going down the list **702**, the filtering component **226** may initially select the first imaging device **704(1)** since the first imaging device **704(1)** includes the highest score **706(1)**, includes the FOV of the first region **708(1)**, and is associated with the selected image **710(1)**. The filtering component **226** may then continue down the list **702** in order to select the second imaging device **704(2)** since the second imaging device **704(2)** includes the second highest score **706(2)**, includes the FOV of the first region **708(1)**, and is associated with the selected image **710(2)**. Next, the filtering component **226** may determine not to select the third imaging device **704(3)** even though the third imaging device **704(3)** has the third highest score **706(3)** and includes the FOV of the second region **708(2)**. This is because the third imaging device **704(3)** is not associated with a selected image. Additionally, the filtering component **226** may determine not to select the fourth imaging device **704(4)** even though the fourth imaging device **704(4)** has the fourth highest score **706(4)** and is associated with a selected image **710(3)**. This is because the fourth imaging device **704(4)** includes the FOV of the first region **708(1)** and the filtering component **226** needs to select at least one imaging device **704** that includes the FOV of the second region **708(2)**.

(75) Rather, the filtering component **226** may select the fifth imaging device **704(5)** since the fifth imaging device **704(5)** includes the fifth highest score **706(5)**, includes the FOV of the second region **708(2)**, and is associated with the selected image **710(4)**. In some examples, since the filtering component **226** has now selected the three imaging devices **704(1)**, **704(2)**, and **704(5)**, the filtering component **226** may refrain from analyzing the rest of the list **702**. Returning back to the example of FIG. 2, the filtering component **226** may then output data **228** representing information about the selected imaging devices. The information for a selected imaging device may include at least an identifier of the imaging device and a timestamp of when the imaging device generated a selected image.

(76) A video-retrieval component **230** may then retrieve the image data representing the videos for the imaging devices selected by the filtering component **226**. In some examples, to retrieve the image data, the video-retrieval component **230** may generate data representing a request, where the request includes at least identifiers of the imaging devices and timestamps indicating starting positions and stopping positions for each of the videos. The video-retrieval component **230** may then send the data to one or more computing devices and, based on sending the data, receive the image data from the one or more computing devices. The video-retrieval component **230** may then output data **232** representing the retrieved image data.

(77) A cropping component **234** may then be configured to crop the videos represented by the retrieved image data. For instance, and for image data (also referred to as “video data”) representing a video, the cropping component **234** may be configured to analyze the image data in order to identify a portion of the image data representing the selected image from the video. In some examples, the cropping component **234** identifies portion of the image data representing the selected image using a timestamp associated with the image. The cropping component **234** may then perform one or more additional processing techniques on the image data.

(78) For instance, FIG. 8 illustrates an example of processing image data representing the image **606(7)** selected with respect to the example of FIG. 6, in accordance with examples of the present disclosure. As shown, in some examples, the cropping component **234** may process the image data by occluding the user (and/or a portion of the user, such as the face of the user) that is depicted by the image **606(7)**. In some examples, the cropping component **234** occludes the user by changing the pixels represented by the user (and/or the portion of the user), such as by shading the pixels represented by the user (which is illustrated in the example of FIG. 8). Additionally, or alternatively, in some examples, the cropping component **234** occludes the user (and/or the portion of the user) by removing at least the portion of the image **606(7)** that depicts the user. In either of the examples, the cropping component **234** may occlude the user (and/or the portion of the user) in

order to prevent a processed image **802** from including any information that may be used to identify the user using the processed image **802**.

(79) In some examples, the cropping component **234** may further process the image data representing the image **602(7)** by cropping the image **602(7)** to depict one or more specific features. The one or more specific features may include, but are not limited to, the inventory location, item(s) located on the inventory location, item(s) being interacted with by the user, and/or any other feature. For instance, and as illustrated by the dashed box included in the processed image **802**, the cropping component **234** may crop the image **602(7)** to only include the inventory location.

(80) In some examples, the cropping component **234** may perform similar processes for the image data representing each of the remaining videos retrieved by the video-retrieval component **230**. Returning to the example of FIG. 2, after processing the image data, the cropping component **234** may output processed image data **236** representing the processed images.

(81) An image uploading-component **238** may then upload the image data **236** representing the images to one or more data stores. In some examples, the image-uploading component **238** may also receive and/or generate a mechanism, such as a link, an address, and/or the like, for retrieving the image data **236** from the data store(s). Additionally, in some examples, the image-uploading component **238** may then output data **240** representing the mechanism along with an indication that the task associated with the request has been completed. Next, an output component **242** may generate data **244** representing a response to the request. In some examples, the response may include at least an indication that the task is complete, an indication that the image data **236** has been uploaded to the data store(s) and is ready to retrieve, the mechanism for retrieving the image data **236**, and/or any other information. Additionally, in some examples, the output component **242** may send the data **244** representing the response to one or more computing devices that initially provided the request.

(82) While the example of FIG. 2 illustrates ten different components performing the processes described above, in other examples, one or more of the components may be combined in a single component. Additionally, in some examples, at least one of the components may be separated into two or more components that are configured to perform the processes described above for the component.

(83) As described herein, the system(s) may determine to update a collection of images, such as by performing the processes described with respect to FIGS. 1-8, based on detecting an event. As such, FIG. 9 illustrates a flow diagram of an example process **900** for detecting an event and then, based on detecting the event, updating a collection of images, in accordance with examples of the present disclosure. At **902**, the process **900** may include detecting an event associated with an item **904** located at an inventory location **906**. For instance, system(s) **908** may detect the event associated with the item **904**. In the example of FIG. 9, the event may include a user **910** interacting with the item **904** at the inventory location **906**.

(84) For a first example, if the user **910** is a customer, the system(s) **908** may detect the event by analyzing image data generated by imaging devices **912(1)-912(2)** (also referred to as “imaging devices **912**”). Based on the analysis, the system(s) **908** may determine that the image data represents the user **910** removing the item **904** from the inventory location **906**, returning the item **904** to the inventory location **906**, and/or rummaging through the items at the inventory location **906**. For a second example, if the user **910** is an associate of the facility, the system(s) **908** may detect the event by again analyzing image data generated by imaging devices **912**. Based on the analysis, the system(s) **908** may determine that the image data represents the user **910** restocking the item **904** at the inventory location **906**. Still, for a third example, the system(s) may detect the event by receiving, from a device **914** associated with the user **910**, data indicating that the event occurred (e.g., the device **914** may scan the item **904**, such as a barcode of the item **904**, and then send the data to the system(s) **908**). For example, the data may indicate that the user **910** restocked

the item **904** at the inventory location **906**.

(85) While these are just a couple examples of events that may be detected, in other examples, the system(s) **908** may detect the event using additional and/or alternative techniques. For a first example, the system(s) **908** may detect the event based on a period of time elapsing. For instance, the system(s) **908** may store information about the images included in the collection of images for the item **904**, such as timestamps indicating when the image data representing the images was generated. The system(s) **908** may then use the timestamps to determine when to update one or more of the images included in the collection of images. For instance, the system(s) **908** may determine to update images after the period of time has elapsed, where the period of time may include one day, one week, one month, one year, and/or any other period of time. As such, when the system(s) **908** determine that the period of time has elapsed, the system(s) **908** may detect the event.

(86) For a second example, the system(s) **908** may detect the event based on a current state of the collection of images. For instance, the system(s) **908** may determine that the collection of images is in a first state when a number of images included in the collection of images is less than a first threshold. The system(s) **908** may also determine that the collection of images is in a second state when the number of images included in the collection of images is greater than the first threshold (and/or between the first threshold and a second threshold).

(87) As described herein, the first state may include a critical state indicating that more images should be added to the collection of images while the second state includes a non-critical state indicating that the collection of images includes an adequate number of images. Additionally, as described herein, a threshold may include, but is not limited to, 10 images, 20 images, 25 images, 40 images, 50 images, 100 images, and/or any other number of images. As such, the system(s) **908** may analyze the collection of images to determine that the collection of images is in the first state. Based on the determination, the system(s) may detect that the event has occurred.

(88) In some examples, the collection of images may be in the first state for one or more reasons. For a first example, the collection of images may be in the first state based on the item including a new item, either at the facility or at all facilities. As such, the system(s) **908** may not have received and/or collected enough images yet for the collection of images. For a second example, the system(s) **908** may automatically remove older images, such as images that were captured and/or collected longer than a threshold period of time ago. This may also cause the number of images within the collection of images to be in the first state. Still, for a third examples, the collection of images may be in the first state based on the system(s) **908** raising the first threshold, such as to make sure that there is an adequate number of images in the collections of images. While these are just a few example reasons of why the collection of images may be in the first state, in other examples, the collection of images may be in the first state for other reasons.

(89) At **916**, the process **900** may include receiving image data **918** representing images **920(1)-(3)** (also referred to as “images **920**”) of the item **904** at the inventory location **906**. For instance, based on detecting the event, the system(s) **908** may cause the imaging devices **912** to generate and/or send the image data **918**. In some examples, the system(s) **908** cause the imaging devices **912** to generate and/or send the image data **918** by sending data to the imaging devices **912**, where the data represents a command to generate and/or send the image data **918**. In some examples, the system(s) **908** may perform one or more of the processes described with respect to FIGS. **1-8** in order to cause the imaging devices **912** to generate and/or send the image data **918**. For instance, the system(s) **908** may perform the processes above to identify and/or score the imaging devices **912**, determine that the image data **918** is not obstructed, crop the image data **918**, obstruct the user **910** represented by the image data **918**, and/or perform one or more other processes described above. While the example of FIG. **9** only illustrates that the image data **918** represents three different images **920**, in other examples, the image data **918** may represent any number of images **920**.

(90) In some examples, such as when the system(s) **908** identify multiple events for multiple items, either at one facility or multiple facilities, the system(s) **908** may prioritize the retrieving of the image data for the items associated with the events. In some examples, the system(s) **908** may prioritize the retrieving of the image data based on the types of events detected by the system(s) **908**. For example, the system(s) **908** may determine a first type of event (e.g., a collection of images being in a critical state) includes a first priority, a second type of event (e.g., a time period elapsing) includes a second priority that is less than the first priority, a third type of event (e.g., a user interacting with an item) includes a third priority that is less than the second priority, and/or so forth.

(91) Additionally, or alternatively, in some examples, the system(s) **908** may prioritize the retrieving of the image data based on the qualities of images included in the collection of images. For example, the system(s) **908** may determine that low quality images include a first priority, medium quality images include a second priority that is less than the first priority, good quality images include a third priority that is less than the second priority, and/or so forth. In some examples, the system(s) **908** determine the quality for an image based on the visibility data, the obstruction data, the type of event that caused the generating of the image, and/or using one or more additional and/or alternative techniques. The system(s) **908** may then use the priorities when retrieving the image data. For example, the system(s) **908** may retrieve the image data associated with item that includes the highest priority, followed by retrieving the image data associated with the item that includes the second highest priority, followed by retrieving the image data associated with the item that includes the third highest priority, and/or so forth.

(92) At **922**, the process **900** may include storing the image data **918** as part of a collection of images associated with the item **904**. For instance, the system(s) **908** may store the image data **918** as part of the collection of images, where the collection of images is represented by collection data **924**. In some examples, the collection of images is associated with the item **904** by associating the collection data **924** with identifier data **926** associated with the item **904**. For instance, the identifier data **926** may represent a name of the item **904**, a code (e.g., a barcode, a Quick Response (QR) code, etc.) of the item **904**, a number (a standard identification number) associated with the item **904**, and/or any other type of data that may be used to identify the item **904**. When storing the image data **918**, the system(s) **908** may use one or more different techniques.

(93) For example, the system(s) **908** may determine a number of images that are currently included in the collection of images. If the system(s) **908** determine that the number of images does not satisfy (e.g., is less than) the second threshold, then the system(s) **908** may store all of the images **920** (e.g., all of the image data **918**) in association with the collection of images as long as the number of images remains below the second threshold. However, if the number of images satisfies (e.g., is equal to or greater than) the second threshold, then the system(s) **908** may replace images already included in the collection of images with the new images **920**. In some examples, the system(s) **908** replace the images based on when the images were generated. For example, the system(s) **908** may use the timestamps to replace the oldest images included in the collection of images. For instance, and in the example of FIG. 9, if the system(s) **908** need to replace three images with the three new images **920**, then the system(s) **908** may remove the three oldest images from the collection of images. The system(s) **908** may then store the image data **918** representing the three new images **920** in association with the collection of images.

(94) Additionally, or alternatively, in some examples, the system(s) **908** may perform additional techniques to replace the images included in the collection of images. For instance, certain types of images may improve the processing that the system(s) **908** later perform when using the collection of images to detect interactions associated with the item **904**. For a first example, images that depict the item **904** after an associate restocks the item **904** (e.g., when the inventory location **906** is in a tidy state) may be better for later processing than images that depict the item **904** after numerous users have interacted with the items at the inventory location **906** (e.g., when the

inventory location **906** is in an untidy state). For a second example, images that depict the item **904** during hours when the facility is open (e.g., when the lighting is adequate) may be better for later processing than images that depict the item **904** during hours when the facility is closed (e.g., when the lighting is not adequate). As such, the system(s) **908** may use these determinations when replacing images included in the collection of images.

(95) For a first example, and again if the system(s) **908** need to replace three images from the collection of images, the system(s) **908** may analyze the images to identify three images that were generated while the inventory location **906** was in an untidy state. The system(s) **908** may then remove those three identified images from the collection of images. Additionally, the system(s) **908** may store the image data **918** representing the three new images **920** in association with the collection of images. For a second example, and again if the system(s) **908** need to replace three images from the collection of images, the system(s) **908** may analyze the images to identify three images that were generated while the facility was closed. The system(s) **908** may then remove those three identified images from the collection of images. Additionally, the system(s) **908** may store the image data **918** representing the three new images **920** in association with the collection of images. Examples of replacing images included in a collection of images is illustrated in the example of FIG. **11**.

(96) At **928**, the process **900** may include identifying an interaction associated with the item **904** using the image data **918** associated with the collection of images. For instance, the system(s) **908** may later receive image data representing a new images **930(1)** depicting the item **904** on the inventory location **906** and/or a new image **930(2)** depicting a user interacting with the item **904**. As such, the system(s) **908** may analyze the image data representing the images **930(1)-(2)** with respect to the image data **918** representing the images **920**. Based on the analysis, the system(s) **908** may determine that the interaction is with the item **904**. For example, based on the analysis, the system(s) **908** may determine that the images **930(1)-(2)** depict the item **904**.

(97) As discussed in the example process **900**, the system(s) **908** may determine priorities for items when detecting events that trigger the generating and/or updating of collections of images. For instance, FIG. **10** illustrates an example of prioritizing items when collecting image data for collections of images, in accordance with examples of the present disclosure. As shown, the system(s) **908** may generate priority data **1002** for various items. The priority data **1002** may include, but is not limited to, item identifiers **1004(1)-(6)** (also referred to as “item identifiers **1004**”), event types **1006(1)-(6)** (also referred to as “event types **1006**”), locations **1008(1)-(6)** (also referred to as “locations **1008**”), times **1010(1)-(6)** (also referred to as “times **1010**”), and priorities **1012(1)-(6)** (also referred to as “priorities **1012**”). However, in other examples, the priority data **1002** may not include one or more of the event types **1006**, the locations **1008**, or the times **1010**. Additionally, in other examples, the priority data **1002** may include additional information about the items.

(98) The item identifiers **1004** may represent identifiers for the items included in the list. As described herein, the identifier for an item may represent a name of the item, a code (e.g., a barcode, a Quick Response (QR) code, etc.) of the item, a number (a standard identification number) associated with the item, and/or any other type of identifier that may be used to identify the item. The event types **1006** may represent the types of events that caused the items to be placed on the list for retrieving new images for the collections of images. As described herein, the event type for an item may include a period of time elapsing since generating previous images, an interaction with the item at an inventory location (e.g., a restocking of the item, a returning of the item, a rummaging through items, etc.), an indication that the item is new at the facility and/or an inventory location, an indication that the item has moved from to a new inventory location, a state associated with the collection of images, and/or any other type of event.

(99) The locations **1008** of the items may include the facilities that the items are located, the inventory locations within the facilities that the items are located, the locations (e.g., coordinates,

such as x-coordinates, y-coordinates, z-coordinates) within the facilities that the items are located, and/or any other location information that may be used to determine where the items are located. Additionally, the times **1010** may represent times that the facilities are open, times that the facilities are closed, times when the image data should be collected, and/or any other timing information. Furthermore, the priorities **1012** may represent the priorities for when to collect the image data. For example, a first item associated with the item identifier **1004(1)** may include the highest priority **1012(1)**, a second item associated with the item identifier **1004(2)** may include the second highest priority **1012(2)**, a third item associated with the item identifier **1004(3)** may include the third highest priority **1012(3)**, and/or so forth.

(100) As such, and in the example of FIG. **10**, the system(s) **908** may initially generate and/or update the collocation of images of the first item based on the priority **1012(1)**, the system(s) **908** may then generate and/or update the collection of images of the second item based on the priority **1012(2)**, the system(s) **908** may then generate and/or update the collection of images of the third item based on the priority **1012(3)**, and/or so forth. However, in some examples, the system(s) **908** may use the times **1010**, in addition to the priorities **1012**, when selecting the order for the items. For instance, the system(s) **908** may determine to update the collection of images for items when the facilities associated with the items are open. For example, if a facility that includes the first item associated with the item identifier **1004(1)** is closed, but a facility that includes the second item associated with the item identifier **1004(2)** is open, then the system(s) **908** may generate and/or update the collection of images associated with the second item before generating and/or updating the collection of images associated with the first item.

(101) FIG. **11** illustrates an example of updating a collection of images associated with an item, in accordance with examples of the present disclosure. In the example of FIG. **11**, the collection of images, which is represented by the collection data **924**, may initially include a first number of images **1104(1)-(N)** (also referred to as “images **1104**”). As shown, each image **1104** may be associated with additional information **1106** that the system(s) **908** may use when updating the collection of images **1102** (although only the additional information **1106** for the first image **1104(1)** is shown for clarity reasons). In the example of FIG. **11**, the additional information **1106** may include at least timestamp data **1108** representing timestamps of when the images **1104** were generated and event data **1110** representing events that caused the generating of the images **1104**. However, in other examples, the additional information **1106** may include any other type of information associated with the images **1104**.

(102) An event-detection component **1112** of the system(s) **908** may perform one or more of the processes described herein in order to detect an event associated with updating the collection of images. As such, the system(s) **908** may receive image data **918** representing at least new images **1114(1)-(X)** (also referred to as “images **1114**”). A collection component **1116** of the system(s) **908** may then perform one or more of the processes described herein in order to update the collection of images using the image data **918**. For a first example, the collection component **1116** may initially determine to replace the image **1104(1)** with a new image **1114(1)** since the image **1104(1)** includes the oldest image from the collection of images. In some examples, the collection component **1116** determines that the image **1104(1)** includes the oldest image based on the timestamp data **1108** associated with the images **1104**.

(103) For a second example, the collection component **1116** may determine to replace the image **1104(5)** with a new image **1114(X)** based on the event data **1110** associated with the images **1104**. For example, the event data **1110** may indicate that the image **1104(5)** was generated after multiple users had rummaged through items located an inventory location associated with the item (e.g., the inventory location was untidy), but that the other images **1104(2)-(4)** and **1104(N)** were generated after associates restocked the items at the inventory location (e.g., the inventory location was tidy). As such, the collection component **1116** may determine that the image **1104(5)** is less reliable when performing processing than the other images **1104(2)-(4)** and **1104(N)** included in the collection of

images. Because of this, the collection component **1116** may replace the image **1104(5)** even though each of the images **1104(2)-(4)** is older than the image **1104(5)**.

(104) While the example of FIG. **11** describes replacing some of the original images **1104** included in the collection of images, in other examples, the collection component **1116** may not replace any of the images **1104**, but may just add the images **1114** to the collection of images. For example, the collection component **1116** may determine that the original number of images included in the collection of images does not satisfy (e.g., is below) the second threshold, which is discussed herein. As such, as long as the total number of images included in the collection of images, even when the new images **1114** are added, still does not satisfy the second threshold, then the collection component **1116** may add the images **1114** to the collection of images.

(105) While the examples of FIGS. **9-11** describe the system(s) **908** as updating a single collection of images for a single item using image data representing images depicting the item, in other examples, the system(s) **908** may update collections of images for multiple items using the image data. For example, and as illustrated at least in the examples of FIGS. **9** and **11**, one or more of the images may depict both the item and another item also located at an inventory location. As such, the system(s) **908** may use the image data representing those image(s) to update both the collection of images associated with the item and the collection of images associated with the other item. This may help improve the processing performed by the system(s) **908**, as the system(s) **908** are able to update collections of images associated with multiple items with only retrieving the image data a single time from the imaging device(s) and/or one or more data stores.

(106) FIGS. **12-13** illustrate various processes for detecting events and retrieving image data representing features within a facility. The processes described herein are illustrated as collections of blocks in logical flow diagrams, which represent a sequence of operations, some or all of which may be implemented in hardware, software or a combination thereof. In the context of software, the blocks may represent computer-executable instructions stored on one or more computer-readable media that, when executed by one or more processors, program the processors to perform the recited operations. Generally, computer-executable instructions include routines, programs, objects, components, data structures and the like that perform particular functions or implement particular data types. The order in which the blocks are described should not be construed as a limitation, unless specifically noted. Any number of the described blocks may be combined in any order and/or in parallel to implement the process, or alternative processes, and not all of the blocks need be executed.

(107) FIG. **12** illustrates a flow diagram of an example process **1200** for retrieving image data representing an area within a facility, in accordance with examples of the present disclosure. At **1202**, the process **1200** may include determining to retrieve image data representing a feature within a facility. For instance, the system(s) **908** may determine to retrieve the image data. As described herein, in some examples, the system(s) **908** determine to retrieve the image data based on detecting the occurrence of an event. Additionally, or alternatively, in some examples, the system(s) **908** determine to retrieve the image data based on receiving a request for the image data, where the request includes information about the feature. For example, the request may include an identifier of the facility, an identifier of the feature, a location associated with the feature, a time period for the image data, and/or any other information. The feature may include an inventory location, region(s) of the inventory location, an item, a location within the facility, and/or any other feature associated with the facility.

(108) At **1204**, the process **1200** may include determining that an imaging device includes a field of view of the feature. For instance, the system(s) **908** may determine that the imaging device includes the FOV of the feature. For example, such as when the feature includes the inventory location, the system(s) **908** may initially determine accessible region(s) of the inventory location. In some examples, the system(s) **908** make the determination based on the type of the inventory location (e.g., a basket, a table, a shelf, a counter, a refrigerator, etc.), which is described in detail herein.

The system(s) **908** may then use the accessible region(s) to determine interested region(s) of the inventory location. After identifying the interested region(s), the system(s) may use the interested region(s) to identify the imaging device that includes the FOV representing the identified region(s). In some examples, the system(s) **908** may perform similar processes in order to identify additional imaging device(s).

(109) At **1206**, the process **1200** may include determining a visibility associated with the imaging device and the feature. For instance, the system(s) **908** may receive and/or generate visibility data representing the visibility associated with the imaging device. As described herein, the visibility data may represent a percentage of first pixels represented by image data that are associated with the feature, a percentage of the first pixels that are associated one or more obstructing objects, a percentage second pixels represented by the image data that are associated with the interested region(s), a percentage of the second pixels that are associated with one or more obstructing objects, a percentage of the feature that is visible from the imaging device, a percentage of the interested region(s) that are visible by the imaging device, an angle (e.g., an angle in the x-direction, an angle in the y-direction, and/or an angle in the z-direction) of the imaging device with respect to the feature, and/or any other visibility information.

(110) At **1208**, the process **1200** may include determining a score associated with the imaging device using the visibility. For instance, the system(s) **908** may be configured to determine the score for the imaging device based on the visibility data, using one or more of the processes described herein. Additionally, when the system(s) **908** are analyzing more than one imaging device, the system(s) **908** may be configured to determine score(s) for each of the other imaging device(s) using visibility data associated with the other imaging device(s). In some examples, the system(s) **908** may then generate list data representing a list for the imaging devices, where the list is ordered based on the scores. For example, the imaging device with the highest score may be first, the imaging device with the second highest score may be second, the imaging device with the third highest score may be third, and/or so forth.

(111) At **1210**, the process **1200** may include determining an occlusion associated with the image data generated by the imaging device. For instance, the system(s) **908** may receive and/or generate occlusion data associated with the imaging device. As described herein, the occlusion data may represent a percentage of the image data that is occluded by one or more users (e.g., the percentage of the pixels that represent the user(s)), a percentage of the first pixels that are obstructed by the user(s) (e.g., the percentage of the feature that is obstructed by the user(s) within the image), a percentage of the second pixel(s) that are obstructed by the user(s) (e.g., the percentage of the interested region(s) that are obstructed by the user(s) within the image), segmented portions of the image data that represent various portions of the user(s) (e.g., pixels that represents a head of a user, pixels that represent the arm of the user, pixels that represent the hand of the user, etc.), and/or any other information. The system(s) may then use one or more of the percentages above in order to select at least an image for the imaging device.

(112) At **1212**, the process **1200** may include determining whether the occlusion satisfies a threshold occlusion. For instance, the system(s) **908** may determine whether the occlusion satisfies the threshold occlusion. In some examples, the system(s) may make the determination by comparing at least one of the percentages to a threshold percentage in order to determine whether the at least one percentage satisfies (e.g., is less than) the threshold percentage or does not satisfy (e.g., is equal to or greater than) the threshold percentage. As described herein, the threshold percentage may include, but is not limited to, 5%, 10%, 20%, and/or any other percentage. If it is determined that the occlusion does not satisfy the threshold occlusion, then at **1214**, the process **1200** may include refraining from using the image data. For instance, if the system(s) **908** determine that the occlusion does not satisfy the threshold occlusion, then the system(s) **908** may refrain from using the image data. Additionally, in some examples, the system(s) **908** may perform similar processes as **1210-1212** to determine whether additional image data generated by the

imaging devices is associated with an occlusion that satisfies the threshold occlusion.

(113) However, it is determined that the occlusion satisfies the threshold occlusion, then at **1216**, the process **1200** may include selecting the image data based at least in part on the score. For instance, if the system(s) **908** determine that the occlusion satisfies the threshold occlusion, then the system(s) **908** may select the image data based at least in part on the score. For example, the system(s) **908** may select the imaging devices that are associated with a top number of scores (e.g., the top two scores, the top three scores, the top ten scores, and/or any other number of scores). Additionally, in some examples, the system(s) **908** may use additional techniques when selecting the image data. For example, the system(s) **908** may select the image data such that there is at least one image that depicts each of the interested region(s) of the inventory location.

(114) At **1218**, the process **1200** may include storing the image data in one or more data stores. For instance, the system(s) **908** may retrieve the image data, such as from one or more computing devices. In some examples, the system(s) **908** retrieve the image data by generating and then sending data representing a request, where the request indicates at least the identifier associated with the imaging device and the timestamp associated with the selected image data. Additionally, in some examples, the system(s) **908** may generate a notification indicating that the image data is stored in the one or more data stores. The notification may include a link, an address, and/or any other mechanism for accessing the image data. The system(s) may then send the notification to one or more computing devices associated with the original request that started the process.

(115) FIG. **13** illustrates a flow diagram of an example process **1300** for generating and/or updating a collection of images associated with an item. At **1302**, the process **1300** may include detecting an event associated with an item. For instance, the system(s) **908** may detect the event associated with the item. As shown, and at **1304**, the system(s) **908** may detect the event by determining that a time period has elapsed. For instance, the system(s) **908** may analyze data associated with a collection of images for the item, where the data indicates at least timestamps of when the images included in the collection of images were generated and/or stored. The system(s) **908** may then analyze the timestamps in order to determine that the time period has elapsed since generating and/or storing at least a portion of the images. As such, the system(s) **908** may detect that the event has occurred.

(116) Additionally, or alternatively, and at **1306**, the system(s) **908** may detect the event by detecting an interaction associated with the item. For instance, the system(s) **908** may receive data. In some examples, the data may include image data generated by one or more imaging devices that include a respective FOV of the item. In such examples, the system(s) **908** may analyze the image data in order to determine that the image data represents an associate and/or user interacting with the item. In some examples, the data may include sensor data generated by a user device of an associate of the facility. In such examples, the system(s) **908** may analyze the sensor data in order to determine that the sensor data represents the associate performing a task associated with the item, such as restocking the item. In either of the examples, the system(s) **908** may detect the event.

(117) Additionally, or alternatively, and at **1308**, the system(s) **908** may detect the event by detecting that the item is new to a facility and/or an inventory location. For instance, the system(s) **908** may receive data. In some examples, the data may include image data generated by one or more imaging devices that include a respective FOV of the item. In such examples, the system(s) **908** may analyze the image data in order to determine that the image data represents the item being new to the facility and/or to the inventory location. In some examples, the data may include identifier data associated with the item. The system(s) **908** may then compare the identifier data to identifier data associated with other items at the facility to determine that the item is new. In either of the examples, the system(s) **908** may detect the event.

(118) Additionally, or alternative, and at **1310**, the system(s) **908** may detect the event by detecting a state associated with a collection of images for the item. For instance, the system(s) **908** may analyze the collection of images in order to determine a number of images that are included in the collection of images. The system(s) **908** may then determine that the collection of images is in a

first state when a number of images included in the collection of images is less than a first threshold. The system(s) **908** may also determine that the collection of images is in a second state when the number of images included in the collection of images is between the first threshold and a second threshold. As described herein, the first state may include a critical state indicating that more images should be added to the collection of images while the second state includes a non-critical state indicating that the collection of images includes an adequate number of images. In some examples, the system(s) **908** detect the event by detecting that the collection of images is in the first state.

(119) At **1312**, the process **1300** may include determining, based at least in part on the event, to retrieve image data representing the item and at **1314**, the process **1300** may include determining a priority associated with retrieving the image data. For instance, the system(s) **908** may determine to retrieve the image data based on detecting the event. The system(s) **908** may then determine the priority associated with the item. In some examples, the system(s) **908** determine the priority using one or more factors. The one or more factors may include, but are not limited to, a type of event, a time period that the facility is open, a time period that the facility is closed, and/or any other factor. In some examples, the system(s) **908** may then generate data representing the priorities for the items.

(120) At **1316**, the process **1300** may include retrieving the image data based at least in part on the priority. For instance, the system(s) **908** may use the priority to retrieve the image data. For example, if the system(s) **908** determine that the priority for the item includes the highest priority, then the system(s) **908** may determine to initially retrieve the image data for the item. However, if the system(s) **908** determine that the priority for the item does not include highest priority, then the system(s) **908** may determine to retrieve image data for at least one higher priority item before retrieving the image data for the item. Additionally, in some examples, the system(s) **908** may use other factors, such as times that the facility is open, when retrieving the image data. For example, even if the system(s) **908** determine that the priority of the item includes the highest priority, the system(s) **908** may still wait to retrieve the image data until the facility is open.

(121) In some examples, the system(s) **908** retrieve the image data by sending, to one or more imaging devices, data representing a request to generate and/or send the image data. In such examples, the system(s) **908** may use processes similar to those discussed above in order to identify the imaging devices. Additionally, or alternatively, in some examples, the system(s) **908** retrieve the image data by sending, to one or more other computing devices that store image data for imaging devices, data representing a request for the image data. In such examples, the request may include at least one identifier of at least one imaging device for retrieving the image data, one or more times for the image data, and/or any other information.

(122) At **1318**, the process **1300** may include storing the image data as part of the collection of images for the item. For instance, the system(s) **908** may store the image data as part of the collection of images. In some examples, such as when the number of images within the collection of images is greater than the second threshold, the system(s) **908** may initially remove one or more images from the collection of images, using one or more of the processes described herein. The system(s) **908** may then add the new image(s) to the collection of images. In some examples, such as when the number of images is less than the second threshold, the system(s) **908** may just add the new image(s) to the collection of images. Additionally, in some examples, the system(s) **908** may continue to repeat the process **1300** starting back at **1302**.

(123) FIGS. **14** and **15** represent an illustrative materials handling environment in which the techniques described herein may be applied to imaging devices monitoring the environments as described below. However, the following description is merely one illustrative example of an industry and environment in which the techniques described herein may be utilized. The materials handling facility **1402** (or “facility”) comprises one or more physical structures or areas within which one or more items **1404(1)**, **1404(2)**, . . . , **1404(Q)** (generally denoted as **1404**) may be held.

As used in this disclosure, letters in parentheses such as “(Q)” indicate an integer result. The items **1404** comprise physical goods, such as books, pharmaceuticals, repair parts, electronic gear, groceries, and so forth.

(124) The facility **1402** may include one or more areas designated for different functions with regard to inventory handling. In this illustration, the facility **1402** includes a receiving area **1406**, a storage area **1408**, and a transition area **1410**. The receiving area **1406** may be configured to accept items **1404**, such as from suppliers, for intake into the facility **1402**. For example, the receiving area **1406** may include a loading dock at which trucks or other freight conveyances unload the items **1404**.

(125) The storage area **1408** is configured to store the items **1404**. The storage area **1408** may be arranged in various physical configurations. In one implementation, the storage area **1408** may include one or more aisles **1412**. The aisle **1412** may be configured with, or defined by, inventory locations **1414** on one or both sides of the aisle **1412**. The inventory locations **1414** may include one or more of shelves, racks, cases, cabinets, bins, floor locations, or other suitable storage mechanisms for holding or storing the items **1404**. The inventory locations **1414** may be affixed to the floor or another portion of the facility's structure, or may be movable such that the arrangements of aisles **1412** may be reconfigurable. In some implementations, the inventory locations **1414** may be configured to move independently of an outside operator. For example, the inventory locations **1414** may comprise a rack with a power source and a motor, operable by a computing device to allow the rack to move from one location within the facility **1402** to another.

(126) One or more users **1416(1)**, **1416(2)** (generally denoted as **1416**), totes **1418(1)**, **1418(2)** (generally denoted as **1418**) or other material handling apparatus may move within the facility **1402**. For example, the users **1416** may move about within the facility **1402** to pick or place the items **1404** in various inventory locations **1414**, placing them on the totes **1418** for ease of transport. An individual tote **1418** is configured to carry or otherwise transport one or more items **1404**. For example, a tote **1418** may include a basket, a cart, a bag, and so forth. In other implementations, other agencies such as robots, forklifts, cranes, aerial drones, and so forth, may move about the facility **1402** picking, placing, or otherwise moving the items **1404**.

(127) One or more sensors **1420** may be configured to acquire information in the facility **1402**. The sensors **1420** in the facility **1402** may include sensors fixed in the environment (e.g., ceiling-mounted cameras) or otherwise, such as sensors in the possession of users (e.g., mobile phones, tablets, etc.). The sensors **1420** may include, but are not limited to, imaging devices **1420(1)**, weight sensors, radio frequency (RF) receivers, temperature sensors, humidity sensors, vibration sensors, and so forth. The sensors **1420** may be stationary or mobile, relative to the facility **1402**. For example, the inventory locations **1414** may contain imaging devices **1420(1)** configured to acquire images of pick or placement of items **1404** on shelves, of the users **1416(1)** and **1416(2)** in the facility **1402**, and so forth. In another example, the floor of the facility **1402** may include weight sensors configured to determine a weight of the users **1416** or another object thereupon.

(128) During operation of the facility **1402**, the sensors **1420** may be configured to provide information suitable for tracking how objects move or other occurrences within the facility **1402**. For example, a series of images acquired by a imaging devices **1420(1)** may indicate removal of an item **1404** from a particular inventory location **1414** by one of the users **1416** and placement of the item **1404** on or at least partially within one of the totes **1418**.

(129) While the storage area **1408** is depicted as having one or more aisles **1412**, inventory locations **1414** storing the items **1404**, sensors **1420**, and so forth, it is understood that the receiving area **1406**, the transition area **1410**, or other areas of the facility **1402** may be similarly equipped. Furthermore, the arrangement of the various areas within the facility **1402** is depicted functionally rather than schematically. For example, multiple different receiving areas **1406**, storage areas **1408**, and transition areas **1410** may be interspersed rather than segregated in the facility **1402**.

(130) The facility **1402** may include, or be coupled to, an inventory management system **1422**,

which may perform some or all of the techniques described above with reference to FIGS. 1-13. For example, the inventory management system **1422** may maintain a virtual cart of each user within the facility **1402**. The inventory management system **1422** may also store a record associated with each user indicating the location of the user, and whether the user is eligible to exit the facility **1402** with one or more items without performing a manual checkout of the items. The inventory management system **1422** may also generate and output notification data to the users **1416**, indicating whether or not they are so eligible.

(131) As illustrated, the inventory management system **1422** may reside at the facility **1402** (e.g., as part of on-premises servers), over network(s) **1430** and on the servers **1432** that are remote from the facility **1402**, a combination thereof. In each instance, the inventory management system **1422** is configured to identify interactions and events with and between users **1416**, devices such as sensors **1420**, robots, material handling equipment, computing devices, and so forth, in one or more of the receiving area **1406**, the storage area **1408**, or the transition area **1410**. As described above, some interactions may further indicate the existence of one or more events **1424**, or predefined activities of interest. For example, events **1424** may include the entry of the user **1416** to the facility **1402**, stocking of items **1404** at an inventory location **1414**, picking of an item **1404** from an inventory location **1414**, returning of an item **1404** to an inventory location **1414**, placement of an item **1404** within a tote **1418**, movement of users **1416** relative to one another, gestures by the users **1416**, and so forth. Other events **1424** involving users **1416** may include the user **1416** providing authentication information in the facility **1402**, using a computing device at the facility **1402** to authenticate the user to the inventory management system **1422**, and so forth. Some events **1424** may involve one or more other objects within the facility **1402**. For example, the event **1424** may comprise movement within the facility **1402** of an inventory location **1414**, such as a counter mounted on wheels. Events **1424** may involve one or more of the sensors **1420**. For example, a change in operation of a sensor **1420**, such as a sensor failure, change in alignment, and so forth, may be designated as an event **1424**. Continuing the example, movement of an imaging device **1420(1)** resulting in a change in the orientation of the field of view **1428** (such as resulting from someone or something bumping the imaging device **1420(1)**) may be designated as an event **1424**.

(132) By determining the occurrence of one or more of the events **1424**, the inventory management system **1422** may generate output data **1426**. The output data **1426** comprises information about the event **1424**. For example, where the event **1424** comprises an item **1404** being removed from an inventory location **1414**, the output data **1426** may comprise an item identifier indicative of the particular item **1404** that was removed from the inventory location **1414** and a user identifier of a user that removed the item.

(133) The inventory management system **1422** may use one or more automated systems to generate the output data **1426**. For example, an artificial neural network, one or more classifiers, or other automated machine learning techniques may be used to process the sensor data from the one or more sensors **1420** to generate output data **1426**. For example, the inventory management system **1422** may perform some or all of the techniques for generating and utilizing a classifier for identifying user activity in image data, as described in detail above. The automated systems may operate using probabilistic or non-probabilistic techniques. For example, the automated systems may use a Bayesian network. In another example, the automated systems may use support vector machines to generate the output data **1426** or the tentative results. The automated systems may generate confidence level data that provides information indicative of the accuracy or confidence that the output data **1426** or the tentative data corresponds to the physical world.

(134) The confidence level data may be generated using a variety of techniques, based at least in part on the type of automated system in use. For example, a probabilistic system using a Bayesian network may use a probability assigned to the output as the confidence level.

(135) Continuing the example, the Bayesian network may indicate that the probability that the item depicted in the image data corresponds to an item previously stored in memory is 98%. This

probability may be used as the confidence level for that item as depicted in the image data.

(136) In another example, output from non-probabilistic techniques such as support vector machines may have confidence levels based on a distance in a mathematical space within which the image data of the item and the images of previously stored items have been classified. The greater the distance in this space from a reference point such as the previously stored image to the image data acquired during the occurrence, the lower the confidence level.

(137) In yet another example, the image data of an object such as an item **1404**, user **1416**, and so forth, may be compared with a set of previously stored images. Differences between the image data and the previously stored images may be assessed. For example, differences in shape, color, relative proportions between features in the images, and so forth. The differences may be expressed in terms of distance with a mathematical space. For example, the color of the object as depicted in the image data and the color of the object as depicted in the previously stored images may be represented as coordinates within a color space.

(138) The confidence level may be determined based at least in part on these differences. For example, the user **1416** may pick an item **1404(1)** such as a perfume bottle that is generally cubical in shape from the inventory location **1414**. Other items **1404** at nearby inventory locations **1414** may be predominantly spherical. Based on the difference in shape (cube vs. sphere) from the adjacent items, and the correspondence in shape with the previously stored image of the perfume bottle item **1404(1)** (cubical and cubical), the confidence level that the user has picked up the perfume bottle item **1404(1)** is high.

(139) In some situations, the automated techniques may be unable to generate output data **1426** with a confidence level above a threshold result. For example, the automated techniques may be unable to distinguish which user **1416** in a crowd of users **1416** has picked up the item **1404** from the inventory location **1414**. In other situations, it may be desirable to provide human confirmation of the event **1424** or of the accuracy of the output data **1426**. For example, some items **1404** may be deemed age restricted such that they are to be handled only by users **1416** above a minimum age threshold.

(140) In instances where human confirmation is desired, sensor data associated with an event **1424** may be processed to generate inquiry data. The inquiry data may include a subset of the sensor data associated with the event **1424**. The inquiry data may also include one or more of one or more tentative results as determined by the automated techniques, or supplemental data. The subset of the sensor data may be determined using information about the one or more sensors **1420**. For example, camera data such as the location of the imaging device **1420(1)** within the facility **1402**, the orientation of the imaging device **1420(1)**, and a field of view **1428** of the imaging device **1420(1)** may be used to determine if a particular location within the facility **1402** is within the field of view **1428**. The subset of the sensor data may include images that may show the inventory location **1414** or that the item **1404** was stowed. The subset of the sensor data may also omit images from other imaging devices **1420(1)** that did not have that inventory location **1414** in the field of view **1428**. The field of view **1428** may comprise a portion of the scene in the facility **1402** that the sensor **1420** is able to generate sensor data about.

(141) Continuing the example, the subset of the sensor data may comprise a video clip acquired by one or more imaging devices **1420(1)** having a field of view **1428** that includes the item **1404**. The tentative results may comprise the “best guess” as to which items **1404** may have been involved in the event **1424**. For example, the tentative results may comprise results determined by the automated system that have a confidence level above a minimum threshold.

(142) The facility **1402** may be configured to receive different kinds of items **1404** from various suppliers and to store them until a customer orders or retrieves one or more of the items **1404**. A general flow of items **1404** through the facility **1402** is indicated by the arrows of FIG. 14. Specifically, as illustrated in this example, items **1404** may be received from one or more suppliers, such as manufacturers, distributors, wholesalers, and so forth, at the receiving area **1406**. In various

implementations, the items **1404** may include merchandise, commodities, perishables, or any suitable type of item **1404**, depending on the nature of the enterprise that operates the facility **1402**. The receiving of the items **1404** may comprise one or more events **1424** for which the inventory management system **1422** may generate output data **1426**.

(143) Upon being received from a supplier at receiving area **1406**, the items **1404** may be prepared for storage. For example, items **1404** may be unpacked or otherwise rearranged. The inventory management system **1422** may include one or more software applications executing on a computer system to provide inventory management functions based on the events **1424** associated with the unpacking or rearrangement. These inventory management functions may include maintaining information indicative of the type, quantity, condition, cost, location, weight, or any other suitable parameters with respect to the items **1404**. The items **1404** may be stocked, managed, or dispensed in terms of countable, individual units or multiples, such as packages, cartons, crates, pallets, or other suitable aggregations.

(144) Alternatively, some items **1404**, such as bulk products, commodities, and so forth, may be stored in continuous or arbitrarily divisible amounts that may not be inherently organized into countable units. Such items **1404** may be managed in terms of measurable quantity such as units of length, area, volume, weight, time, duration, or other dimensional properties characterized by units of measurement. Generally speaking, a quantity of an item **1404** may refer to either a countable number of individual or aggregate units of an item **1404** or a measurable amount of an item **1404**, as appropriate.

(145) After arriving through the receiving area **1406**, items **1404** may be stored within the storage area **1408**. In some implementations, like items **1404** may be stored or displayed together in the inventory locations **1414** such as in bins, on shelves, hanging from pegboards, and so forth. In this implementation, all items **1404** of a given kind are stored in one inventory location **1414**. In other implementations, like items **1404** may be stored in different inventory locations **1414**. For example, to optimize retrieval of certain items **1404** having frequent turnover within a large physical facility **1402**, those items **1404** may be stored in several different inventory locations **1414** to reduce congestion that might occur at a single inventory location **1414**. Storage of the items **1404** and their respective inventory locations **1414** may comprise one or more events **1424**.

(146) When a customer order specifying one or more items **1404** is received, or as a user **1416** progresses through the facility **1402**, the corresponding items **1404** may be selected or “picked” from the inventory locations **1414** containing those items **1404**. In various implementations, item picking may range from manual to completely automated picking. For example, in one implementation, a user **1416** may have a list of items **1404** they desire and may progress through the facility **1402** picking items **1404** from inventory locations **1414** within the storage area **1408**, and placing those items **1404** into a tote **1418**. In other implementations, employees of the facility **1402** may pick items **1404** using written or electronic pick lists derived from customer orders. These picked items **1404** may be placed into the tote **1418** as the employee progresses through the facility **1402**. Picking may comprise one or more events **1424**, such as the user **1416** in moving to the inventory location **1414**, retrieval of the item **1404** from the inventory location **1414**, and so forth.

(147) After items **1404** have been picked, they may be processed at a transition area **1410**. The transition area **1410** may be any designated area within the facility **1402** where items **1404** are transitioned from one location to another or from one entity to another. For example, the transition area **1410** may be a packing station within the facility **1402**. When the item **1404** arrives at the transition area **1410**, the items **1404** may be transitioned from the storage area **1408** to the packing station. The transitioning may comprise one or more events **1424**. Information about the transition may be maintained by the inventory management system **1422** using the output data **1426** associated with those events **1424**.

(148) In another example, if the items **1404** are departing the facility **1402** a list of the items **1404**

may be obtained and used by the inventory management system **1422** to transition responsibility for, or custody of, the items **1404** from the facility **1402** to another entity. For example, a carrier may accept the items **1404** for transport with that carrier accepting responsibility for the items **1404** indicated in the list. In another example, a customer may purchase or rent the items **1404** and remove the items **1404** from the facility **1402**. The purchase or rental may comprise one or more events **1424**.

(149) The inventory management system **1422** may access or generate sensor data about the facility **1402** and the contents therein including the items **1404**, the users **1416**, the totes **1418**, and so forth. The sensor data may be acquired by one or more of the sensors **1420**, data provided by other systems, and so forth. For example, the sensors **1420** may include imaging devices **1420(1)** configured to acquire image data of scenes in the facility **1402**. The image data may comprise still images, video, or a combination thereof. The image data may be processed by the inventory management system **1422** to determine a location of the user **1416**, the tote **1418**, the identifier of the user **1416**, and so forth. As used herein, the identity of the user may represent a unique identifier of the user (e.g., name, number associated with user, username, etc.), an identifier that distinguishes the user amongst other users being located within the environment, or the like.

(150) The inventory management system **1422**, or systems coupled thereto, may be configured to associate an account with the user **1416**, as well as to determine other candidate users. An account of the user **1416** may be determined before, during, or after entry to the facility **1402**.

(151) In some instances, the inventory management system **1422** groups users within the facility into respective sessions. That is, the inventory management system **1422** may utilize the sensor data to determine groups of users that are effectively “together” (e.g., shopping together). In some instances, a particular session may include multiple users that entered the facility **1402** together and, potentially, that navigate the facility together. For example, when a family of two adults and two children enter the facility together, the inventory management system may associate each user with a particular session. Locating groups in addition to individual users may help in determining the outcome of individual events, given that users within a session may not only individually order, pick, return, or otherwise interact with items, but may also pass the items back and forth amongst each other. For instance, a child in the above example may pick the box of cereal before handing the box to her mother, who may place it in her tote **1418**. Noting the child and the mother as belonging to the same session may increase the chances of successfully adding the box of cereal to the virtual shopping cart of the mother.

(152) By determining the occurrence of one or more events **1424** and the output data **1426** associated therewith, the inventory management system **1422** is able to provide one or more services to the users **1416** of the facility **1402**. By utilizing one or more facility associates to process inquiry data and generate response data that may then be used to produce output data **1426**, overall accuracy of the system may be enhanced. The enhanced accuracy may improve the user experience of the one or more users **1416** of the facility **1402**. In some examples, the output data **1426** may be transmitted over network(s) **1430** to one or more servers **1432** (e.g., remote system(s)).

(153) FIG. **15** illustrates a block diagram of the system(s) **1432**. The system(s) **1432** may be physically present at the facility **1402**, may be accessible by the network(s) **1430**, or a combination of both. The system(s) **1432** do not require end-user knowledge of the physical location and configuration of the system that delivers the services. Common expressions associated with the system(s) **1432** may include “on-demand computing,” “software as a service (SaaS),” “cloud services,” “data centers,” “remote system(s)”, and so forth. Services provided by the system(s) **1432** may be distributed across one or more physical or virtual devices.

(154) The system(s) **1432** may include one or more hardware processors **1502** (processors) configured to execute one or more stored instructions. The processor(s) **1502** may comprise one or more cores. The system(s) **1432** may include one or more input/output (I/O) interfaces **1504** to

allow the processor **1502** or other portions of the system(s) **1432** to communicate with other devices. The I/O interface(s) **1504** may comprise Inter-Integrated Circuit (I2C), Serial Peripheral Interface bus (SPI), Universal Serial Bus (USB) as promulgated by the USB Implementers Forum, and so forth.

(155) The system(s) **1432** may also include one or more communication interfaces **1508**. The communication interface(s) **1508** are configured to provide communications between the system(s) **1432** and other devices, such as the sensors **1420**, the interface devices, routers, and so forth. The communication interface(s) **1508** may include devices configured to couple to personal area networks (PANs), wired and wireless local area networks (LANs), wired and wireless wide area networks (WANs), and so forth. For example, the communication interface(s) **1508** may include devices compatible with Ethernet, Wi-Fi™, and so forth. The system(s) **1432** may also include one or more busses or other internal communications hardware or software that allow for the transfer of data between the various modules and components of the servers **1432**.

(156) The system(s) **1432** may also include a power supply **1540**. The power supply **1540** is configured to provide electrical power suitable for operating the components in the system(s) **1432**.

(157) The system(s) **1432** may further include one or more memories **1510**. The memory **1510** comprises one or more computer-readable storage media (CRSM). The CRSM may be any one or more of an electronic storage medium, a magnetic storage medium, an optical storage medium, a quantum storage medium, a mechanical computer storage medium, and so forth. The memory **1510** provides storage of computer-readable instructions, data structures, program modules, and other data for the operation of the servers **1432**. A few example functional modules are shown stored in the memory **1510**, although the same functionality may alternatively be implemented in hardware, firmware, or as a system on a chip (SOC).

(158) The memory **1510** may include at least one operating system (OS) component **1512**. The OS component **1512** is configured to manage hardware resource devices such as the I/O interface(s) **1504**, the communication interface(s) **1508**, and provide various services to applications or components executing on the processor(s) **1502**. The OS component **1512** may implement a variant of the FreeBSD™ operating system as promulgated by the FreeBSD Project; other UNIX™ or UNIX-like variants; a variation of the Linux™ operating system as promulgated by Linus Torvalds; the Windows® Server operating system from Microsoft Corporation of Redmond, Washington, USA; and so forth.

(159) One or more of the following components may also be stored in the memory **1510**. These components may be executed as foreground applications, background tasks, daemons, and so forth. Communication component(s) **1514** may be configured to establish communications with one or more of the sensors **1420**, one or more of the devices used by associates, other system(s) **1432**, or other devices. The communications may be authenticated, encrypted, and so forth.

(160) The memory **1510** may store an inventory management system **1516**. The inventory management system **1516** is configured to provide the inventory functions as described herein with regard to the inventory management system **1422**. For example, the inventory management system **1516** may track movement of items **1404** in the facility **1402**, generate user interface data, and so forth.

(161) The inventory management system **1516** may access information stored in one or more data stores **1518** in the memory **1510**. The data store(s) **1518** may use a flat file, data stores, linked list, tree, executable code, script, or other data structure to store the information. In some implementations, the data store(s) **1518** or a portion of the data store(s) **1518** may be distributed across one or more other devices including other servers **1432**, network attached storage devices, and so forth.

(162) The data store(s) **1518** may include physical layout data **1520**. The physical layout data **1520** provides a mapping of physical locations within the physical layout of devices and objects such as the sensors **820**, inventory locations **814**, and so forth. The physical layout data **1520** may indicate

the coordinates within the facility **1402** of an inventory location **814**, sensors **820** within view of that inventory location **814**, and so forth. For example, the physical layout data **1520** may include camera data comprising one or more of a location within the facility **1402** of an imaging device **820(1)**, orientation of the imaging device **820(1)**, the operational status, and so forth. Continuing example, the physical layout data **1520** may indicate the coordinates of the imaging device **820(1)**, pan and tilt information indicative of a direction that the field of view **1428** is oriented along, whether the imaging device **1420(1)** is operating or malfunctioning, and so forth.

(163) In some implementations, the inventory management system **1516** may access the physical layout data **1520** to determine if a location associated with the event **1424** is within the field of view **1428** of one or more sensors **1420**. Continuing the example above, given the location within the facility **1402** of the event **1424** and the camera data, the inventory management system **1516** may determine the imaging devices **1420(1)** that may have generated images of the event **1424**.

(164) The item data **1522** comprises information associated with the items **1404**. The information may include information indicative of one or more inventory locations **1414** at which one or more of the items **1404** are stored. The item data **1522** may also include order data, SKU or other product identifier, price, quantity on hand, weight, expiration date, images of the item **1404**, detail description information, ratings, ranking, and so forth. The inventory management system **1516** may store information associated with inventory management functions in the item data **1522**.

(165) The data store(s) **1518** may also include sensor data **1524**. The sensor data **1524** comprises information acquired from, or based on, the one or more sensors **1420**. For example, the sensor data **1524** may comprise 3D information about an object in the facility **1402**. As described above, the sensors **1420** may include an imaging device **1420(1)**, which is configured to acquire one or more images. These images may be stored as the image data **1526**. The image data **1526** may comprise information descriptive of a plurality of picture elements or pixels. Non-image data **1528** may comprise information from other sensors **1420**, such as input from microphones, weight sensors, and so forth.

(166) User data **1530** may also be stored in the data store(s) **1518**. The user data **1530** may include identity data, information indicative of a profile, purchase history, location data, and so forth. Individual users **1416** or groups of users **1416** may selectively provide user data **1530** for use by the inventory management system **1516**. The individual users **1416** or groups of users **1416** may also authorize collection of the user data **1530** during use of the facility **1402** or access to user data **1530** obtained from other systems. For example, the user **1416** may opt-in to collection of the user data **1530** to receive enhanced services while using the facility **1402**.

(167) In some implementations, the user data **1530** may include information designating a user **1416** for special handling. For example, the user data **1530** may indicate that a particular user **1416** has been associated with an increased number of errors with respect to output data **1426**. The inventory management system **1516** may be configured to use this information to apply additional scrutiny to the events **1424** associated with this user **1416**. For example, events **1424** that include an item **1404** having a cost or result above the threshold amount may be provided to a facility associate for processing regardless of the determined level of confidence in the output data **1426** as generated by the automated system.

(168) The inventory management system **1516** may include one or more of a location component **1532**, identification component **1534**, event-determination component **1536**, and an inquiry component **1538**.

(169) The location component **1532** functions to locate items **1404** or users **1416** within the environment of the facility **1402** to allow the inventory management system **1516** to assign certain events to the correct users **1416**. That is, the location component **1532** may assign unique identifiers to users **1416** as they enter the facility and, with the users' consent, may locate the users **1416** throughout the facility **1402** over the time they remain in the facility **1402**. The location component **1532** may perform this locating using sensor data **1524**, such as the image data **1526**.

For example, the location component **1532** may receive the image data **1526** and may use techniques to identify users **1416** from the images. After identifying a particular user **1416** within the facility **1402**, the location component **1532** may then locate the user **1416** within the images as the user **1416** moves throughout the facility **1402**. Further, should the location component **1532** temporarily “lose” a particular user **1416**, the location component **1532** may again attempt to identify the users **1416** within the facility **1402** based on techniques.

(170) Therefore, upon receiving the indication of the time and location of the event in question, the location component **1532** may query the data store **1518** to determine which one or more users **1416** were at or within a threshold distance of the location of the event at the particular time of the event. Further, the location component **1532** may assign different confidence levels to different users **1416**, with the confidence levels indicating how likely it is that each corresponding user **1416** is the user **1416** that is in fact associated with the event of interest.

(171) The location component **1532** may access the sensor data **1524** in order to determine this location data of the user **1416** and/or items **1404**. The location data provides information indicative of a location of an object, such as the item **1404**, the user **1416**, the tote **1418**, and so forth. The location may be absolute with respect to the facility **1402** or relative to another object or point of reference. Absolute terms may comprise a latitude, longitude, and altitude with respect to a geodetic reference point. Relative terms may include a location of 25.4 meters (m) along an x-axis and 75.2 m along a y-axis as designated by a floor plan of the facility **1402**, 5.2 m from an inventory location **1414** along a heading of 1615°, and so forth. For example, the location data may indicate that the user **1416(1)** is 25.2 m along the aisle **1412(1)** and standing in front of the inventory location **814**. In comparison, a relative location may indicate that the user **1416(1)** is 32 cm from the tote **818** at a heading of 73° with respect to the tote **1418**. The location data may include orientation information, such as which direction the user **1416** is facing. The orientation may be determined by the relative direction the user's **1416** body is facing. In some implementations, the orientation may be relative to the interface device. Continuing the example, the location data may indicate that the user **1416(1)** is oriented with a heading of 0°, or looking north. In another example, the location data may indicate that the user **1416** is facing towards the interface device.

(172) The identification component **1534** is configured to identify an object. In one implementation, the identification component **1534** may be configured to identify an item **1404**. In another implementation, the identification component **1534** may be configured to identify the user **1416**. For example, the identification component **1534** may use various techniques to process the image data **1526** and determine the user **1416** depicted in the images by comparing the characteristics in the image data **1526** with previously stored results. The identification component **1534** may also access data from other sensors **1420**, such as from an RFID reader, an RF receiver, and so forth.

(173) The event-determination component **1536** is configured to process the sensor data **1524** and generate output data **1426**, and may include components described above. The event-determination component **1536** may access information stored in the data store(s) **1518** including, but not limited to, event-description data **1542**, confidence levels **1544**, or threshold values **1546**. In some instances, the event-determination component **1536** may be configured to perform some or all of the techniques described above with regards to the event-determination component **1536**. For instance, the event-determination component **1536** may be configured to create and utilize event classifiers for identifying events (e.g., predefined activity) within image data, potentially without use of other sensor data acquired by other sensors in the environment.

(174) The event-description data **1542** comprises information indicative of one or more events **824**. For example, the event-description data **1542** may comprise predefined profiles that designate movement of an item **1404** from an inventory location **1414** with the event **1424** of “pick”. The event-description data **1542** may be manually generated or automatically generated. The event-

description data **1542** may include data indicative of triggers associated with events occurring in the facility **1402**. An event may be determined as occurring upon detection of the trigger. For example, sensor data **1524** such as a change in weight from a weight sensor **1420** at an inventory location **1414** may trigger detection of an event of an item **1404** being added or removed from the inventory location **1414**. In another example, the trigger may comprise an image of the user **1416** reaching a hand toward the inventory location **1414**. In yet another example, the trigger may comprise two or more users **1416** approaching to within a threshold distance of one another.

(175) The event-determination component **1536** may process the sensor data **1524** using one or more techniques including, but not limited to, artificial neural networks, classifiers, decision trees, support vector machines, Bayesian networks, and so forth. For example, the event-determination component **1536** may use a decision tree to determine occurrence of the “pick” event **1424** based on sensor data **1524**. The event-determination component **1536** may further use the sensor data **1524** to determine one or more tentative results **1548**. The one or more tentative results **1548** comprise data associated with the event **1424**. For example, where the event **1424** comprises a disambiguation of users **1416**, the tentative results **1548** may comprise a list of possible user **1416** identities. In another example, where the event **1424** comprises a disambiguation between items, the tentative results **1548** may comprise a list of possible item identifiers. In some implementations, the tentative result **1548** may indicate the possible action. For example, the action may comprise the user **1416** picking, placing, moving an item **804**, damaging an item **804**, providing gestural input, and so forth.

(176) In some implementations, the tentative results **1548** may be generated by other components. For example, the tentative results **1548** such as one or more possible identities or locations of the user **1416** involved in the event **1424** may be generated by the location component **1532**. In another example, the tentative results **1548** such as possible items **1404** that may have been involved in the event **1424** may be generated by the identification component **1534**.

(177) The event-determination component **1536** may be configured to provide a confidence level **1544** associated with the determination of the tentative results **1548**. The confidence level **1544** provides indicia as to the expected level of accuracy of the tentative result **1548**. For example, a low confidence level **1544** may indicate that the tentative result **1548** has a low probability of corresponding to the actual circumstances of the event **1424**. In comparison, a high confidence level **1544** may indicate that the tentative result **1548** has a high probability of corresponding to the actual circumstances of the event **1424**.

(178) In some implementations, the tentative results **1548** having confidence levels **1544** that exceed the threshold may be deemed to be sufficiently accurate and thus may be used as the output data **1556**. For example, the event-determination component **1536** may provide tentative results **1548** indicative of the three possible items **1404(1)**, **1404(2)**, and **1404(3)** corresponding to the “pick” event **1424**. The confidence levels **1544** associated with the possible items **1404(1)**, **1404(2)**, and **1404(3)** may be 25%, 70%, 92%, respectively. Continuing the example, the threshold value **1546** may be set such that confidence level **1544** of 95% are deemed to be sufficiently accurate. As a result, the event-determination component **1536** may designate the “pick” event **1424** as involving item **1404(3)**.

(179) The inquiry component **1538** may be configured to use at least a portion of the sensor data **1524** associated with the event **1424** to generate inquiry data **1550**. In some implementations, the inquiry data **1550** may include one or more of the tentative results **1548** or supplemental data **1552**. The inquiry component **1538** may be configured to provide inquiry data **1550** to one or more devices associated with one or more human associates.

(180) An associate user interface is presented on the respective devices of associates. The associate may generate response data **1554** by selecting a particular tentative result **1548**, entering new information, indicating that they are unable to answer the inquiry, and so forth.

(181) The supplemental data **1552** comprises information associated with the event **1424** or that

may be useful in interpreting the sensor data **1524**. For example, the supplemental data **1552** may comprise previously stored images of the items **1404**. In another example, the supplemental data **1552** may comprise one or more graphical overlays. For example, the graphical overlays may comprise graphical user interface elements such as overlays depicting indicia of an object of interest. These indicia may comprise highlights, bounding boxes, arrows, and so forth, that have been superimposed or placed atop the image data **1526** during presentation to an associate.

(182) The inquiry component **1538** processes the response data **1554** provided by the one or more associates. The processing may include calculating one or more statistical results associated with the response data **1554**. For example, statistical results may include a count of the number of times associates selected a particular tentative result **1548**, determination of a percentage of the associates that selected a particular tentative result **1548**, and so forth.

(183) The inquiry component **1538** is configured to generate the output data **1556** based at least in part on the response data **1554**. For example, given that a majority of the associates returned response data **1554** indicating that the item **1404** associated with the “pick” event **1424** is item **1404(1)**, the output data **1426** may indicate that the item **1404(1)** was picked.

(184) The inquiry component **1538** may be configured to selectively distribute inquiries to particular associates. For example, some associates may be better suited to answering particular types of inquiries. Performance data, such as statistical data about the performance of the associates, may be determined by the inquiry component **1538** from the response data **1554** provided by the associates. For example, information indicative of a percentage of different inquiries in which the particular associate selected response data **1554** that disagreed with the majority of associates may be maintained. In some implementations, test or practice inquiry data **1550** having a previously known correct answer may be provided to the associate for training or quality assurance purposes. The determination of the set of associates to use may be based at least in part on the performance data.

(185) By using the inquiry component **1538**, the event-determination component **1536** may be able to provide high reliability output data **1556** that accurately represents the event **1424**. The output data **1556** generated by the inquiry component **1538** from the response data **1554** may also be used to further train the automated systems used by the inventory management system **1516**. For example, the sensor data **1524** and the output data **1556**, based on response data **1554**, may be provided to one or more of the components of the inventory management system **1516** for training in process improvement. Continuing the example, this information may be provided to an artificial neural network, Bayesian network, and so forth, to further train these systems such that the confidence level **1544** and the tentative results **1548** produced in the future for the same or similar input is improved.

(186) As further illustrated in the example of FIG. **15**, the system(s) **1432** may include the event-detection component **1112**, the collection component **1116**, and an image-retrieval component **1558**. The image-retrieval component **1558** may be configured to perform one or more of the processes described herein with respect to the retrieving image data representing images. For example, the image-retrieval component **1558** may include one or more of the validation component **204**, the parsing component **210**, the visibility component **214**, the STS component **218**, the occlusion-detection component **222**, the filtering component **226**, the video-retrieval component **230**, the cropping component **234**, the image-uploading component **238**, and the output component **242**. FIG. **15** further illustrates that the system(s) **1432** may include the request data **206**, visibility data **1560**, obstruction data **1562**, and feature data **1564**, which are described in more detail above.

(187) FIG. **16** illustrates an example of an environment **1600** that includes distributed systems that communicate to perform one or more processes described herein, in accordance with examples of the present disclosure. As shown, the environment **1600** may include at least image-retrieval system(s) **1602**, image-collection system(s) **1604**, item-identification system(s) **1606**, video-storage

system(s) **1608**, device-visibility system(s) **1610**, and obstruction-detection system(s) **1612**. Each of the systems **1602-1612** may communicate with one another using network(s) **1614**. While the example of FIG. **16** illustrates each of the system **1602-1612** as being separate from one another, in other examples, one or more of the systems **1602-1612** may be combined into a single system.

(188) The image-retrieval system(s) **1602** may be configured to perform one or more of the processes described herein with respect to retrieving image data representing images. For example, the image-retrieval system(s) **1602** may include the image-collection component **1558** for retrieving image data. The image-collection system(s) **1604** may be configured to perform one or more of the processes described herein with respect to detecting events and then generating and/or updating collections of images for items. For example, the image-collection system(s) **1604** may include the event-detection component **1112** and/or the collection component **1116**. The item-identification system(s) **1606** may be configured to perform one or more of the processes described herein with respect to identifying events within a facility. For example, the item-identification system(s) **1606** may include at least the inventory management system **1516**.

(189) The video-storage system(s) **1608** may be configured to store image data representing videos, send data representing information about the videos (e.g., the resolutions, the identifiers of the imaging devices, etc.), receive data representing requests for the image data, and then send the image data based on the requests. For example, after the image-retrieval system(s) **1602** select image data for retrieval, the video-storage system(s) **1608** may receive data representing a request for the image data, where the request includes at least an identifier of an imaging device and a time associated with the image data. The video-storage system(s) **1608** may then identify the image data using the request. For example, the video-storage system(s) **1608** may use the identifier to identify the imaging device and then use the time to identify the image data, for the imaging device, that corresponds to the time (e.g., that was generated during the time). The video-storage system(s) **1608** may then send the image data to the image-retrieval system(s) **1602**.

(190) The device-visibility system(s) **1610** may be configured to generate and/or store the feature data **1564** and/or the visibility data **1560** described herein. Additionally, the device-visibility system(s) **1610** may be configured to provide the feature data **1564** and/or the visibility data **1560** to one or more of the other systems. For example, the device-visibility system(s) **1610** may receive, from the image-retrieval system(s) **1602**, data (e.g., request data **206**) representing a request for visibility information associated with imaging device(s). For example, the request may include an identifier of a facility, an identifier of an inventory location within the facility, an identifier of an item, a location (e.g., coordinates) within the facility, and/or any other information for identifying imaging device(s). The device-visibility system(s) **1610** may then use the request to identify imaging device(s) that includes FOV(s) relevant to the request. Additionally, the device-visibility system(s) **1610** may send, to the image-retrieval system(s) **1602**, the visibility data **1560** associated with the identified imaging device(s).

(191) The obstruction-detection system(s) **1612** may be configured to generate and/or store the obstruction data **1562** described herein. Additionally, the obstruction-detection system(s) **1612** may be configured to provide the obstruction data **1562** to one or more of the other systems. For example, the obstruction-detection system(s) **1612** may receive, from the image-retrieval system(s) **1602**, data (e.g., request data **106**) representing a request for obstruction information associated with imaging device(s). For example, the request may include identifier(s) of the imaging device(s), time period(s) associated with requested video(s), and/or any other information. The obstruction-detection system(s) **1612** may then use the request to identify image data for the imaging device(s) as well as the obstruction data **1562** associated with the image data. Additionally, the obstruction-detection system(s) **1612** may send, to the image-retrieval system(s) **1602**, the obstruction data **1562**.

(192) Embodiments may be provided as a software program or computer program product including a non-transitory computer-readable storage medium having stored thereon instructions

(in compressed or uncompressed form) that may be used to program a computer (or other electronic device) to perform processes or methods described herein. The computer-readable storage medium may be one or more of an electronic storage medium, a magnetic storage medium, an optical storage medium, a quantum storage medium, and so forth. For example, the computer-readable storage media may include, but is not limited to, hard drives, floppy diskettes, optical disks, read-only memories (ROMs), random access memories (RAMs), erasable programmable ROMs (EPROMs), electrically erasable programmable ROMs (EEPROMs), flash memory, magnetic or optical cards, solid-state memory devices, or other types of physical media suitable for storing electronic instructions. Further, embodiments may also be provided as a computer program product including a transitory machine-readable signal (in compressed or uncompressed form). Examples of machine-readable signals, whether modulated using a carrier or unmodulated, include, but are not limited to, signals that a computer system or machine hosting or running a computer program can be configured to access, including signals transferred by one or more networks. For example, the transitory machine-readable signal may comprise transmission of software by the Internet.

(193) Separate instances of these programs can be executed on or distributed across any number of separate computer systems. Thus, although certain steps have been described as being performed by certain devices, software programs, processes, or entities, this need not be the case, and a variety of alternative implementations will be understood by those having ordinary skill in the art.

(194) Additionally, those having ordinary skill in the art readily recognize that the techniques described above can be utilized in a variety of devices, environments, and situations. Although the subject matter has been described in language specific to structural features or methodological acts, it is to be understood that the subject matter defined in the appended claims is not necessarily limited to the specific features or acts described. Rather, the specific features and acts are disclosed as exemplary forms of implementing the claims.

(195) While the foregoing invention is described with respect to the specific examples, it is to be understood that the scope of the invention is not limited to these specific examples. Since other modifications and changes varied to fit particular operating requirements and environments will be apparent to those skilled in the art, the invention is not considered limited to the example chosen for purposes of disclosure, and covers all changes and modifications which do not constitute departures from the true spirit and scope of this invention.

Claims

1. A system comprising: one or more processors; and one or more computer-readable media storing instructions that, when executed by the one or more processors, cause the one or more processors to perform operations comprising: receiving first image data generated by a first camera device located within a facility, the first image data representing first images depicting an item at an inventory location; storing the first image data as part of a collection of images; determining, based at least in part on the first image data, whether first unobstructed imagery of the inventory location is available within a threshold time since a time associated with a last stored image of the collection of images; receiving second image data generated by a second camera device, the second image data representing second images depicting the item at the inventory location; storing the second image data as part of the collection of images; determining, based at least in part on the second image data, whether second unobstructed imagery of the inventory location is available within the threshold time since the time associated with the last stored image of the collection of images; in response to the first unobstructed imagery being available, selecting a first still image from the first unobstructed imagery as an image for the inventory location; in response to the first unobstructed imagery being unavailable and the second unobstructed imagery being available, selecting a second still image from the second unobstructed imagery as the image for the inventory location; in

response to the first unobstructed imagery and the second unobstructed imagery being unavailable, selecting a third still image from the first image data as the image in response to an occlusion percentage of an occlusion of the inventory location in the third still image being less than a threshold percentage; determining an item identifier associated with the item depicted in the image; and storing the image with metadata including the item identifier and a timestamp associated with capture of the image.

2. The system as recited in claim 1, the operations further comprising: determining that a period of time has elapsed since the time associated with the last stored image of the collection of images; based at least in part on the period of time elapsing, processing the first image data and the second image data to determine the image; and cropping the image to exclude extraneous imagery unrelated to the inventory location.

3. The system as recited in claim 1, the operations further comprising: determining a number of images included in the collection of images; determining a duration since the time associated with the last stored image; removing the last stored image from the collection of images in response to at least one of: the number of images in the collection of images reaching or exceeding a threshold number; or the duration reaching or exceeding a threshold duration.

4. The system as recited in claim 1, the operations further comprising: calculating the occlusion percentage using a first number of pixels representing the occlusion of the inventory location and a second number of pixels representing the inventory location.

5. The system as recited in claim 1, wherein the occlusion includes at least one of: a person located between the inventory location and the first camera; or an item that is not designated for placement at the inventory location.

6. A computer-implemented method, comprising: receiving a first video from a first camera located in a facility, the first camera having a first field of view (FOV) that includes an inventory location; receiving a second video from a second camera located in a facility, the second camera having a second FOV that includes the inventory location; determining a time associated with a last stored image of a collection of images associated with the inventory location; analyzing the first video to determine whether first unobstructed imagery of the inventory location is available within a threshold time since the time associated with the last stored image of the collection of images associated with the inventory location; analyzing the second video to determine whether second unobstructed imagery of the inventory location is available within the threshold time since the time associated with the last stored image of the collection of images associated with the inventory location; in response to the first unobstructed imagery being available, selecting a first still image from the first unobstructed imagery as an image for the inventory location; in response to the first unobstructed imagery being unavailable and the second unobstructed imagery being available, selecting a second still image from the second unobstructed imagery as the image for the inventory location; in response to the first unobstructed imagery and the second unobstructed imagery being unavailable, selecting a third still image from the first video as the image in response to an occlusion percentage of an occlusion of the inventory location in the third still image being less than a threshold percentage; and storing, for inclusion in the collection of images in association with the inventory location, the image and a timestamp associated with capture of the image.

7. The computer-implemented method as recited in claim 6, further comprising: cropping the image to exclude extraneous imagery unrelated to the inventory location.

8. The computer-implemented method as recited in claim 6, further comprising: generating a score for the image based at least in part on a camera that captured the image and any occlusion included in the image.

9. The computer-implemented method as recited in claim 6, further comprising: calculating the occlusion percentage using a first number of pixels representing the occlusion of the inventory location and a second number of pixels representing the inventory location.

10. The computer-implemented method as recited in claim 6, wherein the occlusion includes at

least one of: a person located between the inventory location and the first camera; or an item that is not designated for placement at the inventory location.

11. The computer-implemented method as recited in claim 6, further comprising: determining that the first video is prioritized over the second video based on a perspective of the inventory location included in the first video.

12. The computer-implemented method as recited in claim 6, further comprising: removing the last stored image from the collection of images in response to at least one of: a quantity of images in the collection of images reaching or exceeding a threshold quantity; or a duration since the time associated with the last stored image reaching or exceeding a threshold duration.

13. The computer-implemented method as recited in claim 6, further comprising: analyzing the image to determine a physical inventory of items stowed at the inventory location.

14. A computer-implemented method, comprising: receiving imagery from a camera located in a facility, the camera having a field of view that includes an inventory location; determining a time associated with a last stored image of a collection of images associated with the inventory location; analyzing the imagery to determine whether unobstructed imagery of the inventory location is available within a threshold time since the time associated with the last stored image of the collection of images associated with the inventory location; in response to the unobstructed imagery being available, selecting a first still image from the unobstructed imagery as an image for the inventory location; in response to the unobstructed imagery being unavailable, selecting a second still image from the imagery as the image in response to an occlusion percentage of an occlusion of the inventory location in the second still image being less than a threshold percentage; and storing, for inclusion in the collection of images in association with the inventory location, the image and a timestamp associated with capture of the image.

15. The computer-implemented method as recited in claim 14, further comprising: associating the image with at least one item identifier of an item depicted in the image and located at the inventory location.

16. The computer-implemented method as recited in claim 14, further comprising: calculating the occlusion percentage using a first number of pixels representing an occlusion of the inventory location and a second number of pixels representing the inventory location.

17. The computer-implemented method as recited in claim 14, wherein the occlusion includes at least one of: a person located between the inventory location and the camera; or an item that is not designated for placement at the inventory location.

18. The computer-implemented method as recited in claim 14, wherein: the imagery includes a video feed received from the camera.

19. The computer-implemented method as recited in claim 14, further comprising: cropping the image to exclude extraneous imagery unrelated to the inventory location.

20. The computer-implemented method as recited in claim 14, further comprising: analyzing the image to determine a physical inventory of at least one item associated with the inventory location.
